ENTREPRENEURSHIP & INNOVATION FOR UNIVERSITIES

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Foreword

PREFACE

This Text ‘’Entrepreneurship & Innovation for Universities" explores how universities can foster entrepreneurial thinking, creativity, and innovation within their academic environments. . Entrepreneurship innovation for universities represents a transformative approach to education and research, empowering individuals and institutions to drive innovation, create value, and make a meaningful impact on the world. By embracing entrepreneurship as a cornerstone of academic excellence, universities are not only preparing future leaders but also shaping a future where innovation serves as a driving force for positive change. The introduction of entrepreneurship education into universities not only benefits individual students but also contributes to broader economic growth, innovation, and societal development. It equips students with the mindset and skills needed to navigate and succeed in an increasingly entrepreneurial world. In recent years, universities worldwide have increasingly recognized the pivotal role of entrepreneurship and innovation in shaping not only academic excellence but also societal impact and economic growth. Embracing an entrepreneurial mindset goes beyond traditional academic pursuits; it encompasses fostering creativity, risk-taking, and the ability to innovate solutions to complex challenges. Entrepreneurship innovation within universities serves as a catalyst for transformative change across multiple dimensions. It equips students, faculty, and researchers with the tools and mindset necessary to identify opportunities, create value, and tackle real-world problems effectively. Moreover, it positions universities as hubs of innovation that drive regional development and global competitiveness. As universities continue to evolve as catalysts for innovation; their commitment to nurturing entrepreneurial talents and fostering collaborative ecosystems will shape the future of education, industry, and entrepreneurship worldwide. This text covers ten chapters ranging from Concepts of Entrepreneurship, theories, rationale and Relevance, Risk –Taking and Value Creation, Entrepreneurship Thinking to Enterprise Networking among others. Each topic was handled by professional Entrepreneurship Educators through intensive research. Reading and studying this text will actually convince you on the reason for NUC to introduce Entrepreneurship Education into universities.

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CHAPTER ONE
CONCEPT OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

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Introduction

Entrepreneurship has been acclaimed the development stimulant in every country of the world. The creation of a country's wealth and dynamism depends on the competitiveness of its firms and this, in turn, relies fundamentally on the capabilities of its entrepreneurs. Entrepreneurship, otherwise the entrepreneurial function can be visualized as the discovery of opportunities and the subsequent creation of new economic activity, often through the creation of a new organisation. The discovery are on new products services, or production processes new strategies and organisational forms and new markets for products and inputs that did not previously exist. **Entrepreneurship is a "process by which individuals either on their own or within organisations pursue economic opportunities**.

Meaning of Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship is defined as an activity that involves the discovery, assessment and utilization of opportunities to introduce new goods and services, markets, processes and raw material that had not existed previously (Mbhele, 2011). The meaning of entrepreneurship subscribe to the notion of innovation as a key element of entrepreneurship which leads to new net business growth.

- Entrepreneurship is the process of identifying business opportunities and gathering the necessary resource to initiate successful business activity.
- Entrepreneurship involves the creation of values through establishing of a business enterprise, which can exist in any situation.
- Entrepreneurship is the process of discovering new ways of combining resources.
- Entrepreneurship connotes the practice of starting a new business or revitalizing existing business in response to identifying opportunities(John-Akamelu & Okolocha, 2021; Abdulahi et al, 2017; &; Shane Venkatataraman, 2002; Kelechi et al, 2012).

The practices of entrepreneurship are carried out by a person called an entrepreneur Sometimes entrepreneurs are seen as almost a fabulous characters who obtained their skills from a unique hereditary combination (Hofstrand, 2022).

Definition of an Entrepreneur

- An entrepreneur is a person who discovers and exploits opportunities, harnesses and obtains the resources necessary to initiate a successful business activity.
- An entrepreneur is a person who organizes, operates and assumes the risk for business ventures
- An entrepreneur is a creator who initiates and motivates the process of change. He is alert to opportunities for trade.
- An entrepreneur is a central key individual in the society who makes things happens for economic development.
- An entrepreneur is a business person who routinely takes risks while planning and arranging initiatives.
- An entrepreneur is a person that identifies business opportunities; accepts risks, uses intuition, initiates new ways of acting for creation of a new enterprise.

Undeniably, entrepreneurs are distinguished by the factors such as innovation, opportunity recognition, process, and growth in a business and employment of strategic management practices in business. Entrepreneur are most involved in finding new and better ways of doing things that are commercialized (Hofsfrand, 2022, Enyekit et al 2017; Ogeifo, 2013).

Successful Characteristics of an Entrepreneur

An entrepreneur is a person who initiates a business venture. There are some essential characteristics of an entrepreneur which are discussed hereunder:

1. Successful entrepreneurs are able to identify potential business opportunities better than most people. Entrepreneurs focus on opportunities not problems and try to learn from failure.
2. Successful entrepreneurs action-oriented which comes from a sense of urgency. Entrepreneurs have a high need for achievement which motivates them to turn their ideas into action.
3. Successful entrepreneurs have a detailed knowledge of the key factors needed for success and have the physical stamina needed to put their lives into their work.

4. Successful entrepreneurs have risk capabilities. Every business has risk of time and money, so entrepreneurs must take risk for as they enter into creativity and innovation initiation.
5. Successful entrepreneurs must have leadership capabilities to lead worker working under him. Thus, entrepreneurs have the capabilities of take quick decisions, adapting with any kind of situation that arise on the enterprise. They are termed to be industrious.
6. Successful entrepreneurs have good and foresights to know about future business environment. Entrepreneurs are dynamic ambitious and desires the need for autonomy (Hofstrand, 2022, Cuervo, et al, 2015, Kirzner, 1997,).

There are other characteristics for successful entrepreneurs. The list is envies. However, successful entrepreneurs exhibit a number of essential qualities or attributes.

Qualities of Successful Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurs may not be the best managers. But there are qualities that successful entrepreneurs exhibit though they may loose interest or not have the skills to manage the business. Most times creating a new business may not result to good operations.

The under listed are the qualities that helped to describe successful entrepreneurs

Vision: Entrepreneurs have dreams of what the future could be like for their business. Most successful entrepreneurs have the ability to implement their vision.

Decisiveness: Most successful entrepreneurs are not into procrastination. Decisions are made promptly, which is a key element in their success.

Perseverance: Successful entrepreneurs implement their business with total devotion. Entrepreneurs never give-up when confronted by challenges that seem overwhelming.

Dedication: Entrepreneurs are totally dedicated to their business, sometimes at reasonable cost to their families, friends and relations. Successful entrepreneurs work laboriously.

Details: Entrepreneurs must be on top of the critical details of starting and growing a business.

Devotion: Successful entrepreneurs must love their initiatives which generate new products and services and makes them so effective in distributing through key employees.

Performers: Entrepreneurs are doers of course of actions, in that they implement ideas as quickly as possible.

Destiny: Entrepreneurs want to be in-charge of their own fate rather than depend on an employer and many more (Hofstrand, 2022, John-Akamelu & Okolocha, 2021; Schumpter, 1934).

Linkage between Entrepreneurship and Entrepreneur

Entrepreneurship is a term which encompasses what entrepreneurs do in terms of identifying a business opportunity of a particular demand thereby undertaking and focusing on a business. the entrepreneurs bear the uncertainty (Profit/loss) as a primary function in establishing an enterprise. There exist a relationship between entrepreneurship and entrepreneur as the process of searching for business opportunity is not possible without a person. The linkage between entrepreneurship and entrepreneur are discussed as stated:

Entrepreneurship	Entrepreneur
Entrepreneurship is a process	Entrepreneur is a person
Entrepreneurship is an organisation	Entrepreneur is an organizer
Entrepreneurship is an innovation	Entrepreneur is an innovator
Entrepreneurship is risk bearing	Entrepreneur is a risk bearer
Entrepreneurship is a vision	Entrepreneur is a visualizer
Entrepreneurship is a motivation	Entrepreneur is a motivator
Entrepreneurship is a leadership	Entrepreneurs are leaders
Entrepreneurship is a creation	Entrepreneur is a creator

Source: Entrepreneurial Management – Unit 1

Relevance of Entrepreneurship Development in Nation Building

The Industrial Revolution of 1760-1850 represents a good evidence of the inherent relevance of small and medium enterprises (SMEs) in nation building though greatly challenged due to economic and technological innovations and industrial liberalization. In developing countries entrepreneurship development in terms of SMEs creation are more important as they are requirements for inclusive and socially sustainable nations. At least 39,654,385 micro, small and medium enterprise (MSMEs) operated in Nigeria as at December 2020 contributing to 48% to the national GDP and account for 96% of businesses and 84% of employment (Small Business Statistics [SBS], 2024).

Through entrepreneurship, the possibility of the equitable distribution of national income is more realistic by providing employment on a large scale, which enhances capital mobilization and human resources. Untapped demands are met and a niche is created at the market, others provide distinct services that cannot be matched by large organisations. Through entrepreneurship the use of local resources are utilized, increases the overall productivity and per capita income due to wealth creation in the form of goods and services. Entrepreneurship process advances the pace of industrialization in the backward areas thereby balancing regional development. Quick return on investment are yielded; promotes competition and hinders monopoly and there are responsiveness of entrepreneurs to innovations, through entrepreneurship (Ogbu & Nwachukwu, 2012, Entrepreneurship Management,2021).

Conclusion

Entrepreneurship activities in any nation play significant roles and are essential for wealth generation, job creation, economic diversification and poverty reduction and many more. These in turn, relies fundamentally on the capabilities of its entrepreneurs.

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CHAPTER TWO

THEORIES, RATIONALE AND RELEVANCE OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Okoye, Nwamaka J. Ph.D and Chinedu Chukwunwa

Introduction

Entrepreneurship plays an important role in the economic development of any nation.

It leads to better standards of living and generates new wealth, as well as increased employment and national income. It is the act of starting a business with the hope of earning a profit. However, our modern perception of entrepreneurship has evolved into recognizing its ability to solve large-scale problems and influence social change. Entrepreneurs also have the opportunity to help bridge the digital gap between those with access to internet and those without. With technological advancements and market demand for new business idea and innovation, the practice of entrepreneurship is growing rapidly. Today, more and more self-motivated individuals are looking to become fully independent in their professional lives and are aspiring to create their own future.

Entrepreneurship can be considered a national asset, and entrepreneurs are the drivers of that asset for any country. It is a dynamic process that creates value, increases wealth and results in improved well-being. Entrepreneurship is important for a number of reasons, from promoting social change to driving innovation. Great entrepreneurs have the ability to change the way we live and work, on local and national bases. If successful, their innovations may improve standards of living, and in addition to creating wealth with entrepreneurial ventures, they also create jobs and contribute to a growing economy. The importance of entrepreneurship is not to be understated.

Theories of Entrepreneurship

There are many theories of entrepreneurship which emphasize the significant roles played by individual entrepreneurs as they combine talents, abilities, and drive to transform resources into profitable undertakings. However, some of the most commonly recognised theories include:

- **Economic Theory of Entrepreneurship**

Generally, the economic theory of entrepreneurship considers the relationship between economic conditions and incentives to arrive at a risk-reward equation that informs a determination on whether or not to pursue a potential venture. This theory assumes that the entrepreneurs is the one responsible for pulling resources, labour, materials and other assets together in order to make their value greater than before, and also introduce changes, innovations, creativity and a new order.

The economic theory of entrepreneurship was propounded by various economists, but some of the notable contributors may include:

1. Joseph Schumpeter(1883-1950): An Austrian-American economist who introducedthe concept of "creative destruction" and emphasized the role of entrepreneurship in driving innovation and economic growth. He was the first major writer to highlight the human agent in the process of economic development, believed that the economy was propelled by the activities of persons. Who also promoted new goods and new methods of production, or to exploit a new source of materials or new market not merely for profit but also for the purpose of creating it. They disrupt existing markets with new products, processes, or business models, thereby creating value and economic development.

2. Richard Cantillon(1680-1734): He was considered the father of entrepreneurship due his contribution to the concept of entrepreneurship as a risk-taking activity.

3. Jean-Baptiste Say (1767-1832): A French economist, he popularised the term "entrepreneur" and emphasized the role of entrepreneurs in creating value and driving economic growth.

4. John Stuart Mill (1806-1873): An English economist who built upon Say's work and highlighted the importance of entrepreneurship in innovation and economic progress.

5. Carl Menger (1840-1921): An Austrian economist and founder of the Austrian school of economics who also highted the importance of market processes, including competition, innovation, and entrepreurship, in driving economic growth and development.

These economists, along with others, have contributed to our understanding of entrepreneurship as a key driver of economic growth and innovation

Knowledge-Based Theory of Entrepreneurship

Knowledge-based theory of entrepreneurship was developed by several scholars, but the key contributors include:

- **Kirzner's Entrepreneurial Alertness**: Israel Kirzner who was an American economist emphasized on the role of entrepreneurs in recognizing and exploiting market opportunities that others overlook. This theory focuses on the entrepreneur's ability to perceive and act on profit opportunities in the market.
- **Stevenson's Entrepreneurial Process**: Howard Stevenson outlines the importance of entrepreneurial leadership, risk-taking, opportunity recognition, vision in driving innovation and growth. He also emphasized on the process of entrepreneurship involving discovery, evaluation, and responding to opportunities, along with the resources and capabilities required to pursue them.
- David Audretsch: An American economist who was considered the founder of the knowledge-based theory of entrepreneurship. His work in the 1990s emphasized on the role of knowledge spillovers and entrepreneurial activity in driving economic growth.
- Zolta Acs: A hungarian-American economist who collaborated with Audretsch and further developed the knowledge-based theory. He further highlighted the importance of entrepreneurshipin knowledge-intensive industries.
- Maryann Feldman: An American economist who made significant contributions to the knowledge-based theory focusing on the role of knowledge spillovers, innovation, and entrepreneurial activity in regional economic development.

Generally, these scholars have collectively shaped our understanding of the knowledge-based theory of entrepreneurship, highlighting the crucial role of knowledge, innovation, and entrepreneurship in driving economic growth and development.

Rationale for Entrepreneurship

This signifies why entrepreneurship is extremely important in our economic world today as individuals and as a nation at large. They are as follows:

1. Creation of new business

Entrepreneurship is essentially the ownership of a business by a single person. The entrepreneurs can run the vast majority of these enterprises entirely by themselves. They assemble and coordinate their operational processes that support other business ventures. It is a sector in which a person might start a business idea that could grow into a large corporation. All big industrial organizations usually begin as small business initiatives. In every economy, entrepreneurship typically offers a diverse range of initiatives that lead to the creation of new businesses.

2. Innovation

Entrepreneurship is the ability to innovate, whether in an established company, a government agency or a new business. It is the process that either generates new wealth-producing resources or enhances the potential of existing resources to create more revenue. It creates new product lines and improves product quality, ideas, technologies and markets and usually makes life easier for both the entrepreneurs and the consumers.

3. Improved standard of living

Entrepreneurs can make current businesses more competitive by offering lower pricing and a wider range of products. Existing firms may rethink their strategies, increase the quality of their products, lower expenses and become more efficient. This competitiveness often encourages businesses and individuals to seek new solutions to enhance their services and, therefore, offers more value for the customer's money. Thus, entrepreneurship may help established companies in the market boost their productivity and performance.

4. Creation of national wealth

Entrepreneurship usually plays a key part in contributing to the country's national economy by generating wealth and paying taxes, which generally adds to a country's gross domestic product (GDP). Entrepreneurs not only invest their own money, but they also draw money from the market. They take advantage of these resources to develop unique products or services and open up new markets, which in turn leads to economic growth. This increase in revenue can significantly improve the national income of a country.

5. Economic Independence

Entrepreneurship can be a path to economic independence for both the country and the entrepreneur. It reduces the nation’s dependence on imported goods and services and promotes

self-reliance. The manufactured goods and services can also be exported to foreign markets, leading to expansion, self-reliance, currency inflow, and economic independence. Similarly, entrepreneurs get complete control over their financial future. Through their hard work and innovation, they generate income and create wealth, allowing them to achieve economic independence and financial security.

6. Community Development

Entrepreneurship promotes economic growth, provides access to goods and services, and improves the overall standard of living. Many entrepreneurs also make a positive impact on their communities and improve their well-being by catering to underserved areas and developing environment-friendly products. Their work can help build stronger, more vibrant communities and promote social and economic development.

Relevance of Entrepreneurship

1. **Adaptability and Resilience**: Entrepreneurs are often at the forefront of adapting to changing market conditions, societal needs, and technological advancements.
2. **Addressing Societal Challenges**: Entrepreneurship plays a crucial role in addressing global challenges such as climate change, healthcare access, and poverty through innovative solutions.
3. **Diversity and Inclusion**: Entrepreneurship encourages diversity in business ownership and leadership, promoting inclusion and equity within the economy.
4. **Regional Development**: Entrepreneurial activities can stimulate regional development by attracting investments, fostering local talent, and creating clusters of innovation.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurship is not just about starting businesses but also about driving innovation, creating jobs, and fostering economic and social development. The theories surrounding entrepreneurship provide frameworks for understanding the entrepreneurial process, while the rationales and relevance underscore its critical role in contemporary economies and societies in the world at large.

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CHAPTER THREE

RISK-TAKING AND VALUE CREATION

(Dr. Ihediwa Augustina/Chioma A. Onyejedum)

Introduction

Risk is the uncertainty of gain or loss. There are two types of risks when making decisions: systematic and unsystematic. Systematic risks are those associated with the entire market such as economic downturns or geopolitical events. Unsystematic risks are specific to a company such as operational inefficiencies, legal issues and changes in product.

Business risk refers to the chances or possibilities of inadequate profits or even losses due to uncertainties like change in taste, preferences of consumers, change in government policy and obsolescence. According to Koontz, O'Donnell and Weihrich (1980), virtually every decision is based on the interaction of a number of critical variables, many of which have an element of uncertainty as well as a high degree of probability. Thus, all intelligent decision makers dealing with uncertainty would like to know the size and the nature of risk they are to take in choosing a course of action. Hence, risk is therefore the chance one takes of losing time and money on a business that may not be profitable. In other words, risk tends to be the probability of an unfortunate occurrence (Regel &Milten, 1966). Nickel and McHugh (1999) defined risk as the chance of loss, the degree of probability of loss and the amount of possible loss. Higher level managers have been observed to be more accustomed to taking higher risks than lower level managers as their decision areas tend to involve larger elements of risks. Miles (2011) observed that business risks can be classified into internal risks and external risks(risks within and outside an organization). In business, failure is not planned, but lack of planning could bring about failure and an entrepreneur irrespective of scale (big or small) should be cautioned to avert failure.

Kinds of Business Risks

Jolly (2003) classified risks into five different types namely; Strategic risks, Financial risks, Operational risks, Compliance risks and other risks.However, two major kinds of business risks according to Akanwa and Agu (2005) are Speculative risk and Pure risk.

1. **Speculative Risk:** This involves looking forward or anticipating the chance of loss or profit. Planning ahead to avert the risk in order to make larger profit, which might turn out to be the other way. Nickel and McHugh (1999) defined speculative risk as that in which the probability of loss may be relatively low and the amount of loss is known. An entrepreneur takes speculative risk hoping to make profit which might not turn out to be so. For instance, an entrepreneur who starts hoarding fuel might be doing so in anticipation of a fuel scarcity based onprevious

experience during December periods.The outcome of this might ultimately result in a loss or profit. Building a new plant is also considered a speculative risk because it might result in a profit or loss.

2. **Pure Risk:**This is otherwise known as calculated risk which is up to 80% certain to take place. In the event that such a situation occurs, the individual or company will face losses; if it does not occur, they gain nothing, though it is generally preferable for it not to happen. This type of risk, which entrepreneurs are particularly concerned about, is known as pure risk. While it cannot be entirely eliminated, it can be mitigated to some extent. For example, accidents are a known risk in the transport business, but they do not prevent entrepreneurs from engaging in this field.

Other Types of Risk

The other risks associated with investments can vary widely and include market, inflationary, liquidity, political, operational, legal, regulatory and business risks

- Market Risk is the possibility that an investments value will fluctuate due to changes in the overall stock market or economy. Market Risk affects stocks more than bonds and includes both short term price volatility and long term trends.
- Inflationary Risk is the danger that rising prices will reduce the purchasing power of an asset held by an investor. This type of risk is especially important for fixed income securties like bonds because their payment levels may not keep up with inflation when prices rise too quickly.
- Liquidity Risk occurs when an investor cannot convert their investments into cash quickly and easily. This type of risk can arise from illiquid markets or low trading volumes, leading, to large price swings or difficulty in selling assets at a fair price
- Political Risk is the chance that a government’s actions could affect the value of an investment. Political risk can include war civil unrest, changes in tax laws and other events that are out of investors control
- Legal or Regulatory Risk is related to the potential for a government to enact laws that adversely affect the value of an investment. This could include changes in tax laws, regulations governing foreign investments or restrictions on certain types of investments.
- Operational Risk involves the possibility of losses due to inadequate operations processes equipment failures, human errors or fraud. Investors need to understand how financial professionals manage and monitor their investments to reduce this type of risk as much as possible

Risks in Business Decisions

Risk-taking is almost synonymous with entrepreneurship. To start and support your own business, you'll have to put your career, personal finances and even your mental health at stake.

For most, the prospect of making your own decisions and being in charge of your own destiny is worth but if you're going to be successful as an entrepreneur, you have to be prepared for the risks and challenges that come with it. The following are seven business decision risks that every entrepreneur must take, from ideation to ongoing development.

1. **Abandoning the steady pay check**: Before you venture into the world of business ownership, you'll first have to say goodbye to your current job, and in some cases, your career. Some people have the luxury of a backup plan as an option to resume your career in case things don't go well in your independent business.
Related Study: It's better to start a business while still in employment else. However, for most starting entrepreneurs, this option is not available resulting in a risky plunge. There's no guarantee of your personal income, especially in the first few months and years of your company's existence, and you'll probably be too busy to secure or sustain an alternative line of income.

2. **Sacrificing personal capital:** Some entrepreneurs are able to start their ventures relying solely on external funding. That usually means a collection of angel investor contributions, government grants and loans, and results from crowd funding campaigns. Other entrepreneurs have to dive into their own bank accounts and personal savings to get things started. You may not need to completely liquidate your nest egg, but you will have to front at least some personal money -- and that means abandoning, or at least diminishing, your safety net.

3. **Relying on cash flow:** Even if you have a line of credit, securing a regular cash flow is difficult and stressful. You can position yourself for a profitable year, but still struggle with the day to day necessities if your revenue doesn't match or exceed your costs in a timely manner. Bills can add up quickly, and if you don't have enough revenue to support your outgoing cash flow, you could run short of money for pay checks or be forced to dip into emergency funds. Be prepared to address it daily, or at least weekly.

3**. Estimating popular interest:** No matter how much research you do or how many tests you complete, you'll never be able to estimate popular interest in your business with perfect accuracy. People are somewhat unpredictable, which could put a giant hole in your otherwise sound plans. Even when all the data appears to be in your favour, there's a chance you're overestimating the interest in your company, and if your projections are off, your entire financial model could implode.

4. **Trusting a key employee:** When you first start a business, you won't have a full team of employees working for you. Instead, you'll probably have a small, tight-knit group of people working tirelessly together in an effort to get things up and running. You'll have to put an overwhelming amount of trust in them, especially if they have special skills that are hard to find and are willing to start work at a lower salary than the industry standard.For example, if you hire a single, experienced lead developer to work on your product over the course of a few months,

you'll need to have absolute trust in their ability to get the job done on time. Otherwise, your timeline (and your product) could be fatally compromised.

5. **Betting on a crucial deadline**: Start-ups are by nature forced into strict timelines for their product launches and milestone goals. Their finances are fragile, and their investors are eager to start seeing the wheels turning As a result, most entrepreneurs are forced to make multiple goals contingent on a handful of deadlines, and those deadlines become absolutely critical. Be prepared to stay up at night worrying about your ability to hit those deadlines, and coming up with contingencies if you cannot.

6. Donating personal time (and health): Entrepreneurship takes a toll on the average person. You'll spend countless hours doing work to make your company successful, and your remaining hours worrying about what you have or have not done

Risk Management

Our business ventures encounter many risks that can affect their survival and growth. As a result, it is important to understand the basic principles of risk management and how they can be used to mitigate the effects of risks on business entities.

Risk management encompasses the identification, analysis and response to risk factors that form part of the life of a business. Effective risk management means attempting to control as much as possible future outcomes by acting proactively rather than reactively. Hence, effective risk management offers the potential to reduce both the possibility of a risk occurring and its potential impact.

Response to Risks

Avoidance: A business strives to eliminate a particular risk by getting rid of its cause.

Mitigation: Decreasing the projected financial value associated with a risk by lowering the possibility of the occurrence of the risk.

Acceptance: In some cases, a business may be forced to accept risk. This option is possible if a business entity develops contingencies to mitigate the impact of the risks should it occur. When curating contingencies, a business needs to implement a problem-solving approach. The result is a well detailed plan that can be executed as soon as the need arises. Such planning will enable a business organization handle barriers or obstructions to its success because it can deal with risks as soon as they arise

Importance of Risk Management

Risk management is an important process because it empowers a business with the necessary tools so that it can adequately identify and deal with potential risks. Once a risk has been identified, it is then easy to mitigate. In addition, risk management provides a business with a

basis upon which it can undertake sound decision-making. For a business, assessment and management of risks is the best way to prepare for eventualities that may come in the way of progress and growth. When a business evaluates its plan for handling potential threats and then develops structures to address them, it unproves its odds of becoming a successful entity. In addition, progressive risk management ensures risks of a high priority are dealt with as aggressively as possible. Moreover the management will have the necessary information that they can use to make informed decisions and ensure that the business remains profitable.

Basic methods for Risk Management includes

- Risk reduction
- Risk avoidance
- Risk sharing or transfer
- Self-insured against risk
- Risk Retention

Risk Reduction: These are actions taken to reduce or control risks. For instance, the use of seat belt reduces or minimizes injury from road accidents especially when a car summersaults. Also, the use of modern electronic gadgets like Closed-Circuit Television (CCTV) cameras also known as video surveillance to reduce crimes (in shops and on streets).

Risk Avoidance: These are actions taken to avoid risks. Some risks are avoidable while some are not. For example, one can avoid entering into social clubs that might endanger his life or life of others. Also, one can avoid moving with someone who has a questionable character.

Risk Sharing or Transfer: This involves using insurance to protect self or organization against financial risk, by transferring part portion of the risk to the insurance company.

Self Insured Against Risk: This is a risk management approach in which an entity sets aside a sum as a protection against a probable loss, instead of transferring the risk by purchasing an insurance policy. For example, self-funded health care, in which the employer ultimately retains the full risk of paving claims, in contrast to traditional insurance, where all risk is transferred to the insurer. Note that not all risks that are insurable, example personal risks such as loss of a job is not insurable. When the risk is not well managed, it could lead to business failure. There are other causes of business failure in Nigeria as outlined by Okpara (2000). They include; insufficient capital, lack of experience, inadequate preparation or lack of planning, poor managerial skill, fraud, poor health, change in government policies and poor motivation.

Risk Retention: This acknowledges the inevitability of certain risks, and interms of health care, it could mean picking a less expensive health insurance plan that has a higher deductible rate

Risk Analysis Processes

Risk analysis is a qualitative problem-solving approach that uses various tools of assessment to work out and rank risks for the purpose of assessing and resolving them

Risk analysis processes are as follows:

1. **Identify existing risks:** Risk Identification mainly involves brainstorming whereby the business gathers its employees together so that they can review all the various Sources of risk. After which all the identified risks are arranged in order of priority, since it is not possible to mitigate all existing risks that can affect a business. Risks deemed more significant are dealt with urgently.
2. **Assess the risks:** In many cases, problem resolution involves identifying the problem and then finding an appropriate solution. The best way a business should handle risks is to locate the cause of the risks by asking the question; what caused such a risk and how could it influence the business?
3. **Develop an appropriate response:** Once a business entity is set on assessing likely remedies to mitigate identified risks and prevent their recurrence, it needs to ask the following questions: What measures can be taken to prevent the identified risk from recurring? Additionally, what is the best approach to undertake if it does reoccur?
4. **Develop preventive mechanisms for identified risks**: Here, the ideas that were found to be useful in mitigating risks are developed into a number of tasks and then with contingency plans that can be deployed in the future. If risks occur, the plans can be put to action.

Value Creation

The right price for a product or service ultimately depends on one factor; the value that it provides for a customer. There are two aspects of value which are objective value and perceived value.

Objective value refers to the price customers would be willing to pay if they perfectly understood the benefits a product or service delivers (Norman M. Scarborough, 2011). Unfortunately, few, if any, customers can see a product's or services' true objective value. Instead, they are more inclined to **Perceived value** which is the value of a product based on their understanding and experiences, which determines the price they are willing to pay.

Value creation is the process of adding value to something. This is to say that, it is the process of producing something which is worth more than the inputs. Usually, the valuable thing can be classified as a product or service offered by a business that provides the solution to a consumer's problem. Value creation can be classified into two types;

- **Physical or Tangible Value Creation:** This is the converting of raw materials and other resources into physical products such as cars, phones, clothes.

- **Virtual or Intangible Value Creation:**This involves converting raw materials and other resources such as food products to digital information products such as video games, music videos.

Importance of Value Creation

- It determines whether a business will be profitable because both sales and costs are based on the value created. This influences how people are motivated to work since they are being rewarded for their contributions according to how much value they can create.
- It contributes to marketing and promotion because all three other components (promotion, pricing and product) rely on understanding value.
- It is also evident when someone turns their passions and skills into a profitable business.
- It is a process of delivering solution to customer's problems.
  It comprises operational efficiency and cost effectiveness within your company.
- It also allows for optimization and the sustainable allocation of resources value creation plan. This serves as a road map for companies to identify, create and realise the maximum amount of value from the resource available to them. Without value creation, businesses wouldn't be in business at all.

Value Creation Plans

In private equity, a value creation plan is a strategic document that outlines how an investor intends to turn a profit from a business venture, and often includes detailed plans for resource allocation and other operations. It serves as a roadmap for companies to identify, create and realise the maximum amount of value from the resource available to them.

Benefits of Value Creation Plan

In developing a value creation plan, it is useful to first have in mind the benefits it will bring to private equity companies some of which includes:

- **Confident Investment Decision Making:**A detailed value creation plan will provide a clear framework for assessing opportunities as well as help firms avoid overpaying for companies with limited potential for improvement.
- **Expedite Due Diligence Process for Many:** For many, due diligence is the most arduous and time consuming stage of the investment process. Having a clear and concise value creation plan will help you assess what specific information you need from the company to streamline the due diligence process.
- **Early Collaboration with Management:** By building a value creation plan early in the process, you can be transparent with management about what improvement will be expected of them post-closing. This helps foster an environment of collaboration and trust that is essential to successful change management.
- **Hit the Ground Running:** Time is money, and a detailed and considered evaluation that's ready to go before closing will help your firm hit the ground running with value

creation initiatives. With everything agreed upon in advance, investors can confidently put their plans straight into action from the start, be it discontinuing a product line, launching a new digital platform, or making structural changes to the organisation.

Steps to Crafting a Value Creation Plan

- **Research Existing Process:** In making or commencing implementation of changes, one needs to understand how the company currently operates; what's working and where there's clear room for development. This includes analysing customer data and market trends.
- **Identify Areas of Growth:**Once you've completed your research, it's time to explore the areas of growth and improvement that can drive value for the company. For example, if you've established that the company has valuable talent and a great work culture, you will want to focus on encouraging and utilising this resource rather than making drastic changes to existing personnel and disrupting the internal environment.
- **Set Actionable Goal/KPIs (Key Performance Indicators): N**ow that you've identified the areas of growth, it's time to get smart (S.M.A.R.T). S.M.A.R.T is an acrimony that stands for Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant and Time bound. It's a useful guide for ensuring you're setting clear and realistic objectives with measurable success criteria that are conducive to success.It's used in many aspects of business such as project management and leadership and can be applied to your value creation plan.
- **Create a Roadmap:** After setting the objectives, the next step is to create a roadmap for achieving them. This involves identifying potential challenges, assigning responsibility for each task, and setting deadlines for their completion.Additionally, it's essential to determine the resources needed to reach your objectives. This could include funds for new hires, investments in technology, or the time required from existing personnel to complete certain tasks.
- **Monitor Progress:** This final step is the post deal stage of the value creation step plan. After launching your value creation plan, you need to monitor progress against the objectives and KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) that were set out in the roadmap. By tracking the metrics such as customer sentiment, brand recommendation scores or product return rates, you can quickly identify any trends in the performance.
  Feedbacks can be assessed, added and updated to the value creation plan.

Ways to Create Value for Others

- **Take interest in other people's passions as much as you want them to be interested in yours:** Actively engage with and support others' interests and hobbies. This mutual interest fosters stronger relationships and shows respect for their personal passions, which can also encourage them to reciprocate.
- **Become a mentor to others less involved in their community:**Share your expertise and experience with those who are new or less engaged in their community. Mentorship can help others grow, navigate challenges, and build their own networks, creating a ripple effect of positive influence.

- **Support a cause with no direct personal benefit:** Contribute to initiatives or causes that you believe in without expecting anything in return. Stepping outside your comfort zone to support such causes can lead to innovative solutions and demonstrate a commitment to the greater good.
- **Invite them to your meeting:** Include others in your meetings or events to broaden perspectives and foster collaboration. By inviting people, you not only share opportunities but also encourage diverse input and strengthen professional connections.
- **Reject the tendency to blame**: When challenges arise, focus on finding solutions rather than assigning blame. Adopting a problem solving mind-set helps create a constructive environment and promotes teamwork and accountability.
- **Confront internal contradictions:** Reflect on and address any inconsistencies between your values and actions. Resolving these contradictions builds trust and authenticity, making your interactions more credible and aligned with your true principles.
- **Practice industrial-strength listening**: Engage in deep, active listening where you fully absorb and consider the perspectives and information shared by others before responding. This approach not only enhances your understanding but also shows that you value and respect the viewpoints of those around you.

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CHAPTER FOUR

ENTREPRENEURIAL THINKING AND CHARACTERISTICS Of ENTREPRENEURS

Anthony Osinachi Okorafor &Anthony Ahuruezenma Apiti

Introduction

Entrepreneurs could be described as visionary and savvy individuals, courageous enough to generate and pursue smart business ideas to successful breakthrough. Their huge success may not be separated from their unique way of approaching issues, which is shaped by what may best be described as the entrepreneurial mindset. Entrepreneurial mindset describes the way of thinking of entrepreneurs otherwise referred to as entrepreneurial thinking. The entrepreneurial thinking determines the actions and reactions (characteristics) of entrepreneurs that translate to success. In this chapter, we examined the entrepreneurial thinking/mindset, types of entrepreneurial thinking, characteristics of entrepreneurs (products of entrepreneurial thinking) and importance of developing entrepreneurial thinking.

Entrepreneurial Thinking/Mindset

Entrepreneurial thinking can be defined as a mindset that embraces critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving, aimed at identifying opportunities, developing creative ideas, considering risks to drive cited possibilities and effectively leveraging resources to create value. It involves a proactive approach to challenges, characterized by an openness to innovation, a willingness to take calculated risks, and the ability to adapt to changing circumstances.

Kuratko et al (2023) emphasize that entrepreneurial thinking involves a unique cognitive process that distinguishes entrepreneurs from non-entrepreneurs. It is more like a state of mind that opens your eyes to new learning opportunities, seeing things differently than the rest of the world and helps you grow in your role. This process includes opportunity recognition, the ability to perceive and act upon opportunities that others overlook, and the inclination to think outside the conventional frameworks. Entrepreneurial thinking encompasses the discovery, evaluation, and exploitation of opportunities, making it a dynamic and continuous process.

The mindset of an entrepreneur is a critical determinant of their ability to innovate, overcome challenges, and achieve long-term success. It shapes how they perceive opportunities, respond to setbacks, and pursue their goals. Entrepreneurial Learning Initiative (ELI, 2024) highlighted five dimensions to entrepreneurial mindset: self-efficacy, locus of control, motivation, resilience and growth mindset. Understanding these mindset dimensions provides valuable insights into the behaviours and attitudes that contribute to entrepreneurial success.

Self-efficacy mindset: Self-efficacy relates to how we feel, think, motivate ourselves, and behave. Individuals with high self-efficacy believe in their ability to pursue and achieve their set goals. According to ELI (2024)high self-efficacy mindsets are more likely to believe that challenges are opportunities to conquer; rather than potential pitfalls to be avoided. Entrepreneurs fit more into this mindset dimension.

Locus of control: there are two locus of control – external and internal. External locus of control holds the view that fate, luck, circumstances, or powerful others somehow control the events in their lives, whereas internal locus of control believes that it's up the individual to determine his/her fate. Entrepreneurial thinking is consistent with internal locus of control.

Fixed or growth mindset: A fixed mindset is characterized by the belief that abilities and intelligence are static traits that cannot be significantly developed. Individuals with a fixed mindset tend to avoid challenges, give up easily when faced with obstacles, and view effort as fruitless if it does not lead to immediate success. This mindset can be particularly limiting for entrepreneurs, as it hinders their willingness to take risks and learn from failures.

In contrast, a growth mindset is based on the belief that abilities and intelligence can be developed through dedication, hard work, and learning from experiences. Entrepreneurs with a growth mindset embrace challenges, persist in the face of setbacks, and see effort as a path to mastery. This mindset is essential for fostering innovation, resilience, and continuous improvement. Dweck (2019) emphasizes that a growth mindset leads to greater resilience and adaptability, as entrepreneurs are more likely to experiment with new ideas and pivot when necessary. Duckworth (2020) shows that individuals with a growth mindset are more likely to set ambitious goals, sustain motivation, and achieve higher levels of performance.

Motivation: Motivation can be internally (intrinsic) or externally (extrinsic). Doing something for its own sake (intrinsic motivation) rather than for external rewards (extrinsic motivation) is the most potent form of motivation (ELI, 2004). Intrinsically motivated individuals tend to have higher levels of engagement and psychological well-being. They also tend to outperform those who are motivated by external rewards like money, letter grades, etc. Thus intrinsic motivated mindset is critical to successful entrepreneurship.

Resilience: Whether we interpret circumstances positively or negatively can have a powerful effect on our ability to persist (ELI, 2004). Successful entrepreneurs and known to display high level of resilience mindset, because they are more optimistic and positive in their view.

Types of Entrepreneurial Thinking

There are several thinking patterns that are integral to the entrepreneurial mindset. These include critical thinking, reflective thinking, creative thinking, lateral thinking, and intuitive thinking. Each of these thinking patterns contributes distinctively to the entrepreneurial process, enhancing decision-making, learning, and innovation.

Critical Thinking: Critical thinking is a fundamental aspect of entrepreneurial thinking, characterized by the ability to analyze situations, identify problems, and evaluate solutions systematically. It involves logical reasoning, the assessment of evidence, and the formulation of well-founded conclusions. According to Facione (2020), critical thinking involves skills such as interpretation, analysis, evaluation, inference, and explanation. Critical thinking enables entrepreneurs to scrutinize assumptions, assess risks, and consider multiple perspectives before arriving at a decision. Entrepreneurs who engage in critical thinking are better equipped to make informed decisions, avoid biases, and tackle complex business challenges.

Reflective Thinking: Reflective thinking involves introspection and self-assessment, enabling entrepreneurs to learn from their experiences, both successes and failures. It is a dialogue between action and reflection, where individuals engage in a cycle of action, reflection, and new action based on insights gained (Schön, 2019) to improve future performance. For entrepreneurs, this means analyzing past business decisions, understanding what worked and what did not and applying these lessons to future endeavours. This thinking pattern enables entrepreneurs to develop emotional resilience to cope with setbacks, maintain motivation, and stay focused on their goals despite challenges (Gibbs, 2020). This is crucial for sustaining entrepreneurial efforts over the long term.

Creative Thinking: Creative thinking is at the heart of entrepreneurial innovation, involving the ability to generate novel ideas, think outside the box, and envision new possibilities. It is the process of exploring new ways of doing things, challenging conventional wisdom, and developing innovative solutions to problems. Creative thinking drives entrepreneurship by enabling entrepreneurs to differentiate their offerings, disrupt markets, and creates unique value propositions. According to Amabile and Pratt (2019), creativity in entrepreneurship involves both divergent and convergent thinking. Divergent thinking is the ability to generate multiple ideas and solutions, while convergent thinking involves refining and selecting the most viable ones. Runco (2021) emphasizes that creative thinking enhances an entrepreneur's ability to innovate continuously and stay ahead of the competition. Entrepreneurs who prioritize creativity often cultivate a work environment that encourages experimentation, open-mindedness, and collaboration. This culture of creativity not only drives innovation but also attracts and retains talented individuals who thrive in dynamic and forward-thinking environments.

Lateral Thinking: Lateral thinking is a way of problem-solving that involves the combination of creativity and logic. Lateral thinking is somewhat more complicated than creative thinking but built on the roots of creativity(Wilde, 2019). It allows the entrepreneur to apply logic to creative endeavours, enabling him to eliminate less viable approaches and significantly reduce the chances of failure. It helps to focus one's time and effort on the most important tasks that provide most value to target audience.

Intuitive Thinking: Intuition is the most powerful type of thinking to reap success. It is so powerful that the best inventors speak about it. Steve Jobs said "intuition is … more powerful than intellect"; and Nikola Tesla affirmed "but instinct is something which transcends knowledge. We have undoubtedly, certain finer fibers that enable us to perceive truths when logical deduction, or any other willful effort of the brain, is futile." (www.azquotes.com). Intuition is the aspect of using one's mind to think of creative solutions while reflecting on personal experience and understanding of how the world works. It is the process of logically connecting all the pieces of imagination and tuning it in with the reality of the world (Wilde, 2019).

Key Characteristics of Entrepreneurs

Connor and Bernal (2020) asserted that "your behavior is directly influenced by the mindset that you adopt". Therefore it is not out of place to say that entrepreneurial mindset translates to a collection of characteristics that enable entrepreneurs to navigate the challenges of business ownership, innovate in dynamic markets, and drive sustainable growth. These traits include:

Vision and Goal Orientation: Visionary entrepreneurs possess a clear and compelling vision of the future they want to create. This vision serves as a guiding light, inspiring them and their teams to pursue ambitious goals. According to Sarasvathy (2022), entrepreneurs with a strong vision are more likely to attract stakeholders who share their passion and commitment, thereby enhancing organizational cohesion and resilience in the face of challenges. For instance, Jeff Bezos' vision of an expansive online marketplace led to the creation of Amazon, revolutionizing global retail and digital commerce.

Opportunity Recognition: Entrepreneurs excel in identifying and seizing opportunities that others may overlook. They possess a keen sense of market trends, customer needs, and technological advancements, allowing them to innovate and create value. Entrepreneurial opportunity recognition involves perceiving and exploiting gaps in the market, often through a combination of creativity and market insight. For example, Mark Zuckerberg identified the potential of social networking to connect people globally, leading to the founding of Facebook, which has since transformed how billions interact online.

Leadership and Team Building: Effective leadership is crucial for entrepreneurs to inspire, motivate, and guide their teams toward achieving shared goals. Leaders like Sheryl Sandberg exemplify the importance of inclusive leadership, fostering a culture of collaboration and empowerment within organizations. Leadership skills encompass strategic decision-making, conflict resolution, and the ability to adapt to changing circumstances (Audretsch and Lehmann, 2023). Entrepreneurs who prioritize team building and leadership development create cohesive teams capable of navigating challenges and capitalizing on opportunities together.

Communication and Networking Abilities: Entrepreneurs must effectively communicate their vision, ideas, and value proposition to stakeholders, including investors, customers, and employees. Strong communication skills enable entrepreneurs to articulate complex concepts clearly, build credibility, and negotiate favorable outcomes. Effective networking is also crucial for entrepreneurs to access resources, gather market intelligence, and form strategic alliances that facilitate business growth. Successful entrepreneurs like Elon Musk leverage their communication and networking abilities to garner support for ambitious ventures such as SpaceX and Tesla.

Financial Acumen and Resource Management: Financial acumen is essential for entrepreneurs to manage resources wisely, make informed financial decisions, and ensure sustainable growth. It involves proficiency in financial planning, budgeting, cash flow management, and risk assessment (Kuratko et al., 2023). Entrepreneurs who prioritize financial acumen can optimize capital allocation, mitigate risks, and maintain financial stability amidst market fluctuations. For example, Jack Ma's strategic financial management played a pivotal role in the rapid expansion of Alibaba Group, positioning it as a global leader in e-commerce and digital payments.

Other important traits of entrepreneurs include resourcefulness, problem solving, empathy, persistence & grit, tenacity and embracing failure, and optimism.

The Importance of Entrepreneurial Thinking in Modern Business

Entrepreneurial thinking has become an important competence for both individuals and organizations. It cuts across the traditional boundaries of business and has become essential in driving innovation, economic growth, and societal progress. According to Neck, Neck, and Murray (2019), entrepreneurial thinking is not confined to starting new businesses but is applicable across various contexts, including corporate settings, social enterprises, and public sector organizations.

Entrepreneurial thinking develops one’s ability to identify marketplace opportunities and discover the most appropriate ways and time to capitalize on them. Sometimes, it is simply referred to as the ability to find and pursue the problem-solution fits. This mindset encourages a range of characteristics that are crucial for navigating the complexities of the contemporary marketplace and seizing new opportunities. It equips individuals and organizations with the ability to identify gaps in the market, foresee emerging trends, and innovates solutions that meet evolving consumer needs. According to Neck et al. (2019), this proactive approach to problem-solving and opportunity recognition is a hallmark of entrepreneurial thinkers, enabling them to stay ahead of the competition and drive growth.

Entrepreneurial thinking is the driving force behind business success in today's competitive landscape. It fosters:

- Adaptability to change and market dynamics.
- The ability to identify and respond to emerging trends.
- A culture of continuous improvement and growth.
- Positive mental attitude and optimism to embrace risk and pursue business goal to successful breakthrough,
- Tenacity and resilience to navigate through business challenges.
- Creativity that drives innovation to stay ahead in the business world.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurial thinking marked by a dynamic mindset and key traits is a cornerstone of modern business success, driving innovation, growth, and societal advancement. It encompasses a mindset that is open to new ideas, willing to take calculated risks, and adept at adapting to changing circumstances. Entrepreneurial thinking is not just about starting new businesses; it is a vital competence that drives innovation and progress across all sectors. When the principles and characteristics of entrepreneurial thinking are embraced, individuals and organizations can navigate the complexities of the dynamic business world, seize new opportunities, and contribute to a changing and thriving economy. The journey of entrepreneurship is one of continuous learning, adaptation, and resilience, laced by a relentless pursuit of innovation and excellence. The good news is one can actually develop the entrepreneurial mindset and characteristics. For further guide on developing entrepreneurial mindset read (ASU, 2021; AOFund, 2024).

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CHAPTER FIVE

CONCEPTS AND DIMENSIONS OF INNOVATION

Okafor Ndu B. Ph.D

Introduction

Innovation is the lifeblood of progress and a cornerstone of competitive advantage in today's dynamic and rapidly evolving world. It drives economic growth, enhances societal well-being, and fosters sustainable development. Every company wants to innovate, stand out in the market, and offer the best to its customers, employees, and partners. But, aside from a brand's dreams and ambitions, like fostering the changes it desires. Innovation is anything that proposes an alternative to something that is done in a certain way, brings economic and behavioral benefits, solves problems, or makes people's daily lives more practical.

Innovation can be related to a product, service, process, market, and means of production, technology, or anything else that brings about a change that becomes sustained and indispensable. For innovation to take place, people and companies use the countless possibilities technology offers. Technology is the basis that supports and enables all types of innovation, since without good tools innovation can come at the wrong time and lose the potential to scale your business. In fact to innovate is to go beyond and exceed the expectations of stakeholders and the market. For this to happen, you need speed, quality, and precision in your business

This chapter delves into the multifaceted nature of innovation, exploring its various concepts and dimensions to provide a comprehensive understanding of this vital phenomenon especially in the business world.

Concept of Innovation

Innovation, at its core, involves the creation and application of new ideas, products, processes, or services that deliver value. It is not merely about invention or the generation of novel concepts; it encompasses the successful implementation and commercialization of these ideas. The distinction between invention and innovation is crucial: while invention is the creation of something new, innovation is the process that brings this newness into practical use. To Drucker

quoted in Okafor (2021) Innovation is an act that contemplates the resources with a new capacity to create wealth. Oslo, (2020) believes that the term innovation is broader in scope and involves the application of an existing concept or practice in a new way. It is also the application of new technology to an already existing product or process to bring about improvement for the organization's benefit. For a better understanding of the difference between the two terms, let us consider these, the telephone is an invention, but the smart phone is an innovation; the motor vehicle is an invention, but the taxi cabs are innovations and the Uber, Lyft,Taxify, Oride, Opay, etc are further innovations. (Anasuya, 2014).

Valenta in Okafor (2018) emphasized in his work on innovations that the current tougher and tougher competition, globalization of production and Markets, as well as implementation of new technologies means that the success of businesses is dependent on effectiveness and intensity of innovation activities. Innovation is a process that is created through interactions between various actors. Each innovation is unique and specific to entrepreneurship. Innovation is more than just an idea or thought. It is bringing an idea to life. Currently, innovation is considered as the decisive condition of a competitive advantage in entrepreneurship. It is a product of creativity.

Innovation according to business dictionary involves deliberate application of information, imagination and initiation in deriving greater or different values from resources. It includes all processes by which new ideas are generated and converted into useful products. Innovation goes with risk-taking. An organization that creates revolutionary products or technologies takes the greater risk because they create new market. Innovation is a specific action of the entrepreneur. It is a means by which the entrepreneur creates new resources to increase his potential for wealth creation. There are other numerous definitions of the concept of "innovation" existing in economic and business literature.

Uzokife (2023) look at innovation in business perspective defining business innovation as a mean of creating new ideas, new product development through research, or improving existing services. The author continued to say that Innovation can be the paramount focus of a business and this can help entrepreneur to progress and become a market leader if the idea was implemented properly. According to Cassidy,(2018) & Oslo, (2020), business innovation is the process of making something new or is an improvement that better serves a business. This can include a new product or service, a workflow improvement, or anything else that improves the business in a new way. Rouse (2014) submits that business innovation is when an

organization introduces new processes, services, or products to affect positive changes in their business. Absolutely, the goal is to reinvigorate the business, creating new value and boosting growth or productivity. It is against this background that Ward quoted in Uzokife (2023) opines that business innovation is a general concept that can apply to many different products, services, efforts, and policies. It can include new products that will better serve customers or a new program that will help employees better communicate about projects they are working on. At the most basic level, innovation comes up with a new way to do things and those new ways of doing things are introduced with the goal of earning the business more money. Any efforts of trying to find new ways of improving a business venture by entrepreneur means dabbling into business innovation. According to these authors, business innovation should enable the achievement of organizational goals with eyes set on accomplishing core business initiatives and aims. Business innovation usually begins with idea generation, then the idea narrowed down during brainstorming sessions, after which leaders consider the business viability, desirability and feasibility of each idea. Business innovation should enhance on existing products, services or processes, and it should solve a problem or reach new customers. More examples of business innovation according to Uzokife (2023) include the introduction of the Dyson vacuum cleaner, whose initiator, James Dyson expressed in the advertisements that he has manufactured a better product by applying industrial cyclone technologies to the household appliance. .

Reasons for Business Innovation

The main reason for business innovation process is for value creation for the organization. This is made possible through creating new revenue opportunities; driving more revenue from existing channels; creating efficiencies that save time, money or both; or from improvements to productivity or performance. In a nut shell, according to Ward & Krippendor quoted in Uzokife (2023) innovation should lead to higher profits, produce a competitive advantage, help the organization to grow, reach and even exceed strategic objectives. Other benefits include better business growth**,** more relevance of business process, product and other aspect of the organization and finally differentiation of business activities to be unique, standing out in the mist of others. (Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD 2019)

Innovative Practices in Business

Schumpeter quoted in Okafor and Uzokife (2021) proposed a list of five innovative practices which could enhance innovative performance. They include:

- Introduction of new products.
- Introduction of new methods of production.
- Opening of new markets.
- Development of new sources of supply for raw materials or other inputs.
- Creation of new market structures in an industry.

The minimum requirement for an innovation is that the product, process, marketing method or organizational method must be new to the company. This includes products, processes and methods that the companies are the first to develop and those that have been adopted from other companies or organizations. A company could make several changes in its method of work, its use of factors of production and the type of output that improves its productivity and commercial performance. From Schumpeter's proposal of innovation, four types of innovations that encompass a wide range of changes in firms' activities were recognized thus;

- Product innovations which involves significant changes in the capabilities of goods or services. Both entirely new goods and services and significant improvements to existing products are included either by quantity or quality.
- Process innovations represent significant changes in the production and delivery methods.
- Organizational innovations refer to the implementation of new organizational methods. These could be changes in business practices, in workplace organization or in the firm's external relations.
- Marketing Innovation involves the implementation of new marketing methods. This includes changes in products design and packaging, in products promotion and placement and in methods for pricing goods and services. (Organizational of Economics Community Development, OECD,2005)

Types of Innovation

Sydle (2023) discussed three types of innovation, they are : radical, incremental, and disruptive

Radical innovation the author explained as one that really changes the circumstances of a brand, whether in terms of market or of business dynamics. It can occur due to a complete change in a company's positioning, work method, processes, services, and products offered, or how it relates to customers.

Incremental innovation; As one that adds new features to a product, brand, or production methods without promoting a very drastic change.

Disruptive innovation, He said to be a technological and behavioral changes which have favored the emergence of disruptive innovation in recent decades.

This type of innovation follows the market more than a specific brand, product, or service. It can be leveraged by something a company has offered and, as a result, made their name, but, in general, it's a scalable change that reaches many people at the same time.

Examples of disruptive innovation include Netflix, as the market used to rely on companies like Blockbuster for movies and TV series. Netflix started offering DVD-by-mail rental services but decided to innovate. Looking from above types of innovation as narrated by Sydle (2023) innovation can take place as Product innovation, which is **e**asily noticed, when innovation actually brings something new to the market. Television, for example, was something innovative when it was invented, bringing image, sound, and entertainment into people's houses. It was a radical innovation then, with acceptance of the public, became disruptive and over time began to rely on incremental innovation. The whole world followed the release of different kinds of TV: color, cable, flat-screen, and, today, smart TV.

Aspect of business where Innovation can occur

In another perspective as discussed by Indeed Career Guide (2024), Innovation can occur as **Service innovation**; A visible example of service innovation is food delivery. For a long time, in order to eat something from a restaurant, customers needed to walk into the place or order takeout. That's when the market innovated and offered delivery service so that customers could order whatever they wanted with just a phone call. Over time, it became possible to order food on websites, and now we can order food on mobile apps at our fingertips.

More so innovation can occur in **production processes**; Here, it is interesting to highlight environmental awareness. Many cosmetic brands, for example, innovate by implementing cruelty-free processes that don’t involve animals. Several companies have worked to increase environmental sustainability.

Innovation in business model

Innovation in the business model is very common in startups. A simple example would be marketplaces. Virtual stores like Amazon mediate between buyers and sellers.

Another example would be virtual banks. Today, there are many financial institutions with no physical facilities for customer service and whose transactions are all performed online.

- **Technological innovation**

Technological innovation is the most evident kind of innovation. The advance of technology brings about many opportunities. Thinking back a few centuries, the Industrial Revolution springs to mind as a good example, since it changed production methods in companies, work methods, and even workers' lives.

- **Logistical innovation**

For a long time, it would take up to a month to receive a letter by mail. For international products, it would take an average of three months. To change this, companies and distributors innovated in logistics, creating storage points and strategic distribution centers. Today, there are apps to hire delivery services and even delivery drones!

- **Marketing innovation**

Ways of acquiring new customers have evolved, and we're seeing more and more innovations in marketing. Sometimes, the way you advertise can be innovative. With the creation of social media, for example, lots of brands innovated by advertising on those platforms instead of newspapers and television.

- **Organizational innovation**

Organizational innovation brings several other kinds of innovation. They concern structural changes and practices that improve productivity, services, products, and processes.

Home offices are an example of organizational innovation, as are management software, customer service chatbots, and trainee programs in which employees get to know all departments of a company before actually working in one of them.

Stages of the innovation process

The stages of the innovation process are simple, and to innovate, you must have a system and repetition. The stages involve

- Idea generation
- Evaluation of the ideas
- Experimentation
- Marketing and
- Follow up

All these stages need to be based on technology. This makes it possible to speed up processes and document versions prior to the innovation, monitor results, compare versions, test, and assess overall performance.

Tips on how to effectively bring innovation to your business

- Involve the whole team
- Treat innovation as a strategic element
- Invest in internal entrepreneurship development
- Empower your employees
- Create an environment that favors innovation
- Develop an innovation process
- Start a high-impact transformation
- Follow the example of large companies

Importance of Innovation

- Innovation helps keep process of organization tight through creating standard and systematize the best work method.
- Help develop creativity, because innovation is creativity in practice
- Increasing the business's competitiveness by adopting strategic resources.
- Increasing productivity by ensuring effective processes, more production control, effective strategy, and more engaged employees.
- Adding value to a product or service: Innovation, boost the marketing of products and services, because it brings something different and unique for your target audience.

- Increasing profits**:** through more productivity in turn brings more attractive business, and more effective management, with these businesses will consequently see greater profits.

Conclusion

Keeping up to date with changes and developments may help an organisation or business unit maximise its success and profitability. Prioritizing innovation is one way a business can benefit from the changes taking place so it can make improvements, develop solutions to challenging situations and add value. Understanding the different forms that innovation can take and what this can look like may help you create and integrate it into your areas of responsibility. Innovation is, at its core, about solving problems — and there are as many ways to innovate as there are different types of problems to solve. Just like we wouldn't rely on a single marketing tactic for the life of an organization, or a single source of financing, we need more of innovation strategies to excel in our businesses.

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CHAPTER SIX

ENTERPRISE FORMATION AND PARTNERSHIP ALLIANCES

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Introduction

An enterprise is a business which has the legal right of its own to operate in a certain region. The formation of enterprises entails processes from determining the type, name and nature of the business enterprise, registration of the business enterprise, deciding the long term and short term goals and strategy formation. This chapter therefore, highlights the concept of business planning and its basic contents, forms of business ownership, business registration and formation of alliances and joint ventures. There are different forms of businesses an entrepreneur or group of entrepreneurs can venture into as a way of creating value. This includes sole proprietorship and partnership businesses. The processes of business formation usually start from business planning. Business plan is an essential step towards entrepreneurship formation irrespective of scale and nature of the business. This chapter further gets the entrepreneur or an intending entrepreneur acquainted with what it takes to get his business registered with Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC). The registration of a newly conceived business with CAC gives the business the legal right to operate in Nigeria.

Basics of Business Planning

Business planning is the processes of setting strategic goals for a business and how those goals will be actualized. The documented output of a business planning process is known as a Business Plan. In order words, a **Business Plan** is a document which contains the detailed aims, strategies and the financial forecasts of a business.

Every business needs a business plan whether it is a start-up, an existing business or an off-shoot of an existing business. The essence of a business plan is highlighted by Katie (2024) to include; strategizing the launch and growth of a business, providing business direction, attracting funding, provides a document that guides internal decision-making guiding long-term operations, providing a framework within which the business operates, and steering a business to success by making a compelling case for sustainability of the enterprise.

Creating a workable business plan involves an initial feasibility study. The essence of this detailed research involving thoughtful analysis and strategic thinking is to gain more understanding of the business industry and how it operates, for the purpose of setting clearer goals and objectives (Sutjipto, Sule, Sucherly, Katum & Prasetio, 2019).

Contents of a business plan

A business plan has six basic contents. These are usually broken into sections as discussed below;

1. **Executive summary**

The executive summary contains a comprehensive summary of the business goals, missions, strategies, products, personnel and every other thing contained in other sections of the business plan. Even though it is the first section in a business plan, it is usually the last to be written because it gives a concise overview of the entire business.

2. **Business Description**

The business description section is a critical component of the business plan which comes immediately after the executive summary. This section provides a summary of the legal status of the business, history, founders, its unique features, products or services and the skills and experiences of the personnel for achieving the long term goals of the business and competitive advantage. It summarizes what the enterprise does in particular, what it plans to do in future and spells out what the business is about and explains the unique competitive advantage that distinguishes the business from others in the industry (Iwere, 2024).

3. **Market analysis**

This section of the business plan is where the entrepreneur demonstrates his knowledge of the industry, competitors, and its Strength, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats (SWOT) for overcoming market competition. The success of your business as an entrepreneur depends on how well you know and understand your industry, your product market, customers, and competitors. An effective market analysis begins with demonstrating knowledge about the economic conditions of the market, changes in consumer behaviour, technological advancements, and determining how the product or service can meet the demands of these changes. This helps to identify growth opportunities and development of a unique selling proposition to set the business apart from its competitors. The anticipation of these challenges sets the stage for creating contingency plans to mitigate negative impact and ensure the enduring success of the business.

4. **Organizational Structure**

The organizational Structure section of the business plan highlights the enterprise's organizational structure, detailing the roles and responsibilities of the executives, the management team, departmental structures, its key personnel and the positions they occupy in the business and the type of business structure (sole proprietorship, partnership, limited liability or a corporation).

This section is aimed at convincing the readers that the business has a transparent organizational structure and competent personnel with clearly defined responsibilities for the achievement of the strategic goals and objectives.

5. **Financial analysis**

The financial analysis section highlights the funding requirements of the business, the proposed use of the fund. For startups and businesses seeking funding, this section specifies the amount of funding needed, the proposed use of funds and the preferred financial arrangements. This section further provides the financial projections of the business's financial performance over the next three to five years, including forecasted income statements, balance sheets, cash flow statements and capital expenditure budgets.

6. **Appendix.**

The appendix section of the business plan is for the presentation of any additional information that supports the data included in the earlier sections of the business plan. This includes business name registration certificate, trademark registration document, legal agreements, curriculum vitae of the key personnel and their certifications, legal agreements such as resumes of the management team, technical specifications and any other relevant documents.

An entrepreneur or an intending entrepreneur is expected to weave together the above first five sections at least in building a sustainable business. There is also an option of outsourcing the drafting of the business plan by way of engaging interactively with a business Consultant providing him answers to key questions regarding your business intentions. After the interactions with the entrepreneur the business consultant goes ahead to craft a befitting business plan for the chosen form of business, from the responses the entrepreneur gave regarding his enterprise and its future plans.

Forms of Business Ownership

There are different forms of businesses which an entrepreneur can venture into. The choice of any type of business usually depends on myriad of factors to be considered as each form of business has its strengths and limitations (Iliemena, Iheduru, Goodluck & Ndah, 2021). The factors in choosing the form business to run includes; availability of capital, extent of control, managerial skills, long term plan of the entrepreneur, continuity, extent of liabilities, and, government regulations and control over the business. However, the forms of business enterprises regarded as profit making organizations by the Nigerian Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA) 2020 are; sole proprietorship, partnership, and company. Others include cooperative business. These are discussed below;

1. **Sole Proprietorship/One-man/ One-person business**

A sole proprietorship business is a form of enterprise, owned and managed by one person. It may be rendering of a certain kind of service (e.g. hair dressing, fashion designing, welding, professional consultancy and services), or buying and selling of certain goods (e.g. footwear, groceries, bracelets, electronics, phone and phone accessories, household wares). The primary source of capital in sole proprietorship business is personal savings of the owner, although the business depends a lot on family and friends for business capital and running assistance as the business grows, and for the continuity of the business, even though the entrepreneur remains the single owner of the business. The owner of a sole proprietorship business is called a sole proprietor or sole trader. A sole proprietor bears the business risk alone and enjoys the business profit alone.

2. **Partnership business**

Partnership is a relationship which subsists between two or more, but not more than 20 persons who agreed to carry on a business for the sake of profit. Partnership business usually comes with an agreement called partnership deed where the terms and conditions of the combined business are stated. The contents of the deed usually include; amount of capital contribution, name of the firm, details of the partners, commence date and duration, profit/loss sharing ratio, duties of each partner, salaries where applicable, procedures for admission of new partner, retirement of a partner and dispute resolution. The partners in business usually bring together their efforts for greater exploits by capital contribution, bringing their respective experiences, skills and labour into the partnership business.

There are different forms of partnership but notable among them are; general partnerships (GP), limited partnerships (LP), and limited liability partnerships (LLP). A limited partnership has at least one general partner and at least one limited partner. The general partner or partners manage the business on a day-to-day basis. LPs are usually used by real estate investors, hedge funds and investment partnerships, family partnerships, etc. Usually, the partners provide capital in exchange for interests in the profits and do not take part in the management of the firm or partnership, nor do they have powers to bind the partnership. However, they may inspect the books and examine the prospects of the enterprise. A Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) is essentially a hybrid business form that combines the benefits of a Partnership and a Limited Liability company. The general partners in partnership business has unlimited liability for the actions of the partnership and that of other partners in the course of the business. The Limited partners' liability to the debt of the partnership business is however, limited to only their capital investment in the business. This means that the partners are liable to the debts incurred within the partnership whereby the business defaults in repayment. This is to the extent of their personal wealth and properties.

3. **Company**

Incorporated companies are also referred to as body corporate or registered company. This type of business is further divided into two; private company, and public company. They have legal personality, that is, they can sue and be sued because they are legal entities distinct and separate from the persons of which they consist upon registration.

Private company

The private company is a type of company owned by small group of individuals usually 2-50 persons and whose shares are not traded in the stock exchange. The shares of a private company are privately sold to investors without the regulations of the Securities and Exchange Commission. The activities of a private company are regulated by the Board.

Public company

A public company is a company whose shares are traded on the stock exchange market. The stock market in Nigeria is named Nigerian Exchange (NGX) Group. The major decisions in a public company are usually a function of shareholders' voting in an annual general meeting (AGM).

Companies are still further classified as company limited by shares, unlimited company and company limited by guarantee.

Limited by shares: when a public company is described as "limited by shares", it means that the liability of members of the company is limited to the amount of unpaid shares held by each member.

Unlimited company

This type of company is the most uncommon of all types of companies incorporated under Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA) 2020. Although an unlimited company has corporate personality and is thus an entity separate from its members, the liability of its members is nonetheless unlimited, just as in a sole proprietorship or general partnership

Company limited by guarantee

Here, the liability of members is limited to the amount they have respectively undertaken to contribute to the assets of the company in the event of it being wound up.

The ability of the private and public companies to raise capital from the public is one of the factors that distinguish them. While the public companies can raise fund from both primary and secondary stock markets, the private companies are legally restricted from doing so (Goodluck, Iliemena & Islam, 2022). Other differences include the requirement for public companies to hold a statutory meeting not later than six months after incorporation, and compulsory holding of annual General meetings in Nigeria by public companies.

Summarily, there are six different types of companies in the Nigerian business environment; namely:

1. Private companies limited by shares
2. Public companies limited by shares
3. Private companies limited by guarantee
4. Public companies limited by guarantee
5. Private unlimited companies and
6. Public unlimited companies.
7.

It is however, worthy of note that a company can be formed for a special purpose through a special Decree, Edict or Act of Parliament. The main aim of such company is usually to regulate, manage, or provide essential services of economic or social significance. Examples of companies that fall within this category in Nigeria include; Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN), Nigerian Communications Commission (NCC), Nigerian Ports Authority (NPA), Federal Radio Corporation of Nigeria (FRCN), Nigerian Television Authority (NTA), Nigerian Railway Corporation (NRC), Nigerian Maritime Administration and Safety Agency (NIMASA), Nigerian National Petroleum Corporation (NNPC), etc. Consequently, they are owned and controlled by government and are not involved in selling of shares to the public.

4. Cooperative business

This is a form of business formed and managed by a defined group of members for the benefit of its members and others who may benefit from its goods and services. It can also be seen as a private business owned and controlled by the people who use its products, supplies or services (CBN Report, 2018). Members in a cooperative business all have equal control, profit sharing and ownership rights unlike in other businesses where control rests on the highest capital contributor or shareholders. Hence, it is rarely classified as profit making venture, rather, a society. Co-operative Societies vary in types and membership sizes, but are all formed to meet the specific objectives of the members, and are structured to adapt to the changing needs of its members. Examples of cooperative business include; credit union, agricultural/farmers' cooperative society, workers' cooperative society, producers' cooperative society, purchaser' cooperative society, housing cooperative society, etc.

Business Registration

The registration of businesses in Nigeria is regulated by the Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA) 2020. In line with the Act, business registration in Nigeria is categorized into two Viz; Business name registration and Registration of companies.

1. **Business Name Registration**

The name by which a business is known and identified is known as Business name. Business name could be the name of the entrepreneur that owns the business or a different name. It is

required by CAMA 2020 that anyone carrying on a business in Nigeria and wishes to have a name, to register the business name before commencing the business but not later than 28 days after commencement. A Business Name is suitable for small and medium enterprises organized as either a general partnership or sole proprietorship. The benefit of running an enterprise with business name is in the marketing it gives your brand and uniquely differentiates your products from that of your competitors. Apart from this, your business name is the first form of contact that potential clients will have with your business. In choosing a suitable business name for your enterprise, giving your business a name that identifies with your target market or industry is extremely important (e.g.; David confectioneries, Somto Bakery, D & G Wears, Purity Kiddies, Brightgolden Foods Enterprise, Jimic house wares, etc). Such chosen names are required to be reserved after checking through with the CAC to ensure there is no existing business with such name. The registration of business name in Nigeria is such an easy one and can be done online from even the comfort of your home.

2. Registration of companies

The registration of companies in Nigeria is done with the CAC in any state whether physical or online. The minimum requirement for registration however, depends on the type of company being registered. A registered company may be;

(a) A company Ltd by shares (S. 21(1)(a) CAMA

(b) A company Ltd by guarantee (S. 21(1)(b) CAMA

(c) An unlimited company (S. 21(1)(c) CAMA.

A private company limited by shares is by law expected to have a Minimum Issued Share Capital (the minimum amount of capital it must raise from its shareholders) of not less than N100, 000 in sharevalues. Upon registration, the name of a private company limited by shares shall end in either “Limited” or “Ltd”. Section 22 (1a) of CAMA, states that a private company is simply a company whose memorandum of association has stated that it is a private company and the company is registered with CAC as a private company.

The name of a public company limited by shares shall end in “PLC” or “Public Limited Company”. According to the Act, what makes a company a public company is simply that its memorandum of association states that the company shall be a “public company” and the Commission has registered it as such. The Minimum Issued Share Capital of a public company is N2, 000,000.

A company may be registered as “Limited by Guarantee”, if it is formed for the promotion of the activities of its members. The activities of its members could be; commerce, agriculture, art, science, religion, sports, culture, education, research, charity, or other similar aims. When such company is registered as limited by guarantee, the income and properties of the company are to

be applied solely in promoting its objectives and CAMA 2020 restricts that a portion thereof be paid or transferred directly or indirectly to the members of the company except as permitted by the Act. This implies that a company with the intention of making profit for its members should not be registered as limited by guarantee.

Section 21(2) of CAMA and Sections 25 & 27(2)(a) permit registration of the unlimited company as either a private or public company. The name of an unlimited company shall end in "Unlimited" or "Ultd"

Registration of cooperative Businesses in Nigeria

Co-operative Societies are governed by the Nigerian Co-operative Societies Act which provide for the registration of Co-operative Societies. The registration of Co-operative Societies is done with the Office of the federal or state cooperative registry which focuses on cooperative principles and membership structure. A cooperative business may also be registered with CAC as Limited Liability Company (LLC). Registering the society with CAC after registration has been made with the Cooperative Registry gives the cooperative business the opportunity to enjoy tax exemptions and be able to operate as an LLC with limited liability of members and gives the business a legal personality. Before registration, the cooperative society is expected to hold a meeting where they decide on; proposed name and location of the Society, aims & objectives of the Society, rules and regulations, by-laws, etc.

The following documents are to be filed during registration with Cooperative Registry even though requirements may vary depending on the particular requirements of the particular state or federal registry;

1. A written Application form
2. By-laws of the cooperative society
3. List of members and their contributions
4. Business plan
5. Feasibility study
6. Passport photograph of the executive members

The following documents are required in the least, if the cooperative society wishes to register with CAC;

1. Application for registration(Form CAC 1)
2. Particulars of Directors (Form CAC 2)
3. Notice of situation of registered office (Form CAC 3)
4. Notice of Appointment of secretary (Form CAC 4)
5. Memorandum and Articles of Association

Forming Business (Partnership) Alliances and Joint Ventures

Business alliances also known as strategic partnership or collaboration are formed when two or more companies agree to work together to achieve a specific business goal or objective.

Types of business alliances

1. **Joint venture:** A joint venture is where two parties (typically corporations) carry on a business together, though not necessarily for profit. It is a collaborative agreement to achieve some specific business goals or projects, sharing resources and risks. No separate legal entity, no shared ownership, partners retain individual ability, shared profit and losses, typically used for specific projects or limited duration e.g. construction projects, oil and gas exploration, real estate development, film and media production.

2. **Strategic partnership**: A long-term agreement between two or more companies to achieve strategic objectives, share resources and joint value creation.

3. **Distribution or Distributive agreement:** This is a contract between two companies for a distribution relation. It is a partnership to distribute each other's products or services by establishing a structured distribution channel to reach customers and protect the market interest of each other.

4. **Licensing agreement:** this is an agreement between two persons, the licensor (owner) and the licensee (user) for the use of an intellectual property or technology in exchange for royalties or any other form of compensation as agreed.

5. **Research and Development (R&D) Partnership**: This is a partnership between two or more companies to share resources, expertise, and risks by jointly conducting research and developing new products or technologies.

Benefits of business alliances

1. Competitive advantage
2. Better access to expertise, capital and new technologies
3. Improvement in product and service offerings
4. Opportunity to share business costs and market risks

Conclusion

The journey into enterprise formation is a gradual process and usually start from conceptualizing the type of business the entrepreneur wants to venture into, its products and service offerings and the intended name for the business. This should be followed by business name or company

registration which will serve to legalize the business and help its brand of products or services stand out identifiably in the market. The choice of the type of business is however dependent on factors including; the amount of available capital, extent control the entrepreneur wishes to have over his business, and the future plans for the business. The type of business an entrepreneur runs determines his extent of liabilities to the business debts. Apart from the known types of businesses, some companies are formed by government through special decrees for special economic or social reasons. An entrepreneur can decide to form business partnership alliances with other businesses. The types of partnership alliances vary and have their unique purposes and benefits for the entrepreneur depending on the intended purpose of the business alliance.

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CHAPTER SEVEN

CONTEMPORARY ISSUES IN ENTREPRENEURSHIP

(Egolum Priscilla Uchenna (Ph.D)

Digitalization is the core of today's new technology that has changed the current business environment by restructuring old ecosystem, changing traditional governance and management models, and in the process, supercharging economic growth. Over the past decade, the rapid growth of digital technology-based entrepreneurial firms has generated a vast body of research devoted to understanding the fundamental nature and consequences of such digital entrepreneurship and innovation (Okorie, & Onuoha,2023).The digital economy refers to any economic sector that is based on digital computing and very widespread communications technologies.

According to Egolum (2023), entrepreneurship can be defined as the process of creating something new with value, by investing necessary time, talent, effort, assuming the accompanying financial, psychological, and social risks and receiving the resulting rewards of monetary and personal satisfaction and independence thereof. Entrepreneur can also be viewed in at least four ways: as the coordinator of other production resources (land, labor, and capital); decision maker under uncertainty; innovator; and the gap filler or input completer.

On the other hand, technology is a branch of knowledge that deal with the mechanical arts, skill and applied sciences which is available to any human society for practical purposes or applications, whether in industry or in our everyday lives. It usually involves specific piece of equipment, but that equipment can be incredibly simple or dazzlingly complex.

Technopreneurship is the latest buzzword in the field of entrepreneurship. It is a fusion of two words, technology, and entrepreneurship which is a kind of entrepreneurship in the field of technology. Technopreneurs are business owners who specialize in technology-based industries and use technology to develop new or innovative goods, through a commercialization process. Their enterprises are characterized by high growth potential and a high reliance on intellectual property and business knowledge.

Technology entrepreneurship is an investment in a project that assembles and deploys specialized individuals and heterogeneous assets, that are intricately related to advances in scientific and technological knowledge for the purpose of creating and capturing.

Early research on digital technology tended to be limited to a focus on information and communication technology systems that could standardize information and allow organizations to rapidly encode, store, formalize and distribute knowledge. More recently, some researchers have broadened the definition of digital technology to include four levels: Equipment, network, service and content. More specifically, digital technology is understood to be comprised of digital components, digital platforms and digital infrastructure.

Digital components refer to the applications or media contents with specific functions and values embedded in digital products or services, such as mobile phone applications.

A digital platform is a set of shared, common services and architectures, such as extensible operating systems like IOS and Android.

Digital infrastructure refers to digital technology tools and systems that provide communication, collaboration or computing capabilities and support resource aggregation, such as network platforms that provide computing, communication and resource aggregation channels.

Innovation and Technology Entrepreneurship

Technovation is a fusion of two coined words "Technology and Innovation". Technology and Innovation entrepreneurship represent the cutting edge of modern business practices, where breakthroughs in science and digital advancements lead to new market opportunities. Technovation delves into the synthesis of inventive tech and business savvy, charting the course for future industry entrepreneurs. These Include:

1. Artificial Intelligence Startups: Disrupting Traditional Marketplaces
2. The Internet of Things (IoT)
3. Blockchain for Business: Beyond Cryptocurrency to Innovation
4. The Rise of EdTech: Transforming Education through Entrepreneurial Ventures
5. Green Tech Entrepreneurship: Sustainable Solutions or Environmental Challenges
6. The Gig Economy and Tech Entrepreneurship: A Synergistic Relationship
7. Cybersecurity Ventures: Entrepreneurial Opportunities in Protecting Digital Assets
8. 3D Printing in Manufacturing Entrepreneurship.
9. Space Tech Entrepreneurship: The New Frontier for Business Innovation.

1. Introduction to AIs impact on Traditional Market

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has emerged as transformative technology that is reshaping various industries including traditional markets. It has the ability to analyze large amounts of data, learn from patterns and make intelligent decisions. One of the significant impacts of AI on traditional market is the automation of repetitive task. AI powered system can handle our everyday, time-consuming activities, freeing up human resources to focus on more complex and strategic tasks. Other benefits of AI include:

- In banking sector, AI chatbots are being used to automate customer support, providing quick and accurate response to common queries, thereby enhancing customer satisfaction and also reduces operation cost for banks.
- AI technologies is improving compliance and anti-money laundering (AML) efforts, using machine algorithms to analyze large volumes of customer data, transactions and external data source, to identify potential money laundering activities or compliance breaches.
- E-commerce grants, like Amazons and Alibaba, leverage AI to provide personalized product recommendations resulting in increased sales and customer satisfaction.
- AI- powered virtual assistants, such as Apple's Siri (founded by **Steve Jobs),**or Amazon's Alexa, are transforming the way people interact with technology, making it more intuitive and user friendly.
- AI algorithms can predict demand patterns, optimize inventory levels, and streamline logistics operations, by analyzing historical data and real time information. This leads to reduced costs, improved efficiency and faster delivery times.
- Companies like Walmart and Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) are using AI algorithms to optimize their supply chain management, resulting in significant cost effective and improved customer service.
- AI can also help retailers in preventing fraud and theft, thereby reducing losses.
- In the healthcare industry, AI is transforming diagnostic and treatment. AI algorithms can predict and prevent readmissions for patients to reduce healthcare cost, analyze medical images such as X-rays and magnetic resonance imaging, thereby enabling more accurate diagnoses of diseases and personalize treatment plans. For instance, Google's DeepMind has developed an AI system that can detect eye disease, such as diabetic retinopathy with a high degree of accuracy, potentially saving millions of people from vision loss.

- Telemedicine platforms powered by AI allow patients to consult with healthcare professionals remotely, thereby reducing the need for in-person visit and improving access to qualify healthcare, especially remote area.

Few tips for businesses looking to leverage AI include:

a. **Invest in Data:** AI algorithms require collecting vast amounts of high-quality data to train, feed and improve their performance.
b. **Collaborating with AI Experts:** Partnering with AI experts or having data scientists can help businesses navigate the complexities of AI implementation and ensure successful integration into existing workflow.
c. **Start Small and Scale Up:** Identifying specific use cases where AI can deliver significant value and start with pilot projects to allows organizations learn and iterate, ultimately scaling up Al initiative across the business.

2. The Internet of Things (IoT) Landscape: A Multidimensional View

The IoT ecosystem is vast multifaceted, encompassing a wide range of devices, protocol and applications. It deals with how to connect, control devices and data for your graduate entrepreneurship business. These include:

a) Device and Sensors: A diverse array of devices lies at the heart of IoT which can be as small as a wearable-fitness trackers or as large as an industrial robot. Sensors also collect data from the physical world and transmit it to the cloud for processing. For instance,
    - Smart Thermostats: These devices adjust room temperature based on occupancy and external conditions.
    - Global Positioning System (GPS): Used for real-time location monitoring of vehicles (such as Uber-cab which was founded by Garrett Camp, a computer programmer in 2009),assets and even pets.
    - Environmental sensors: Measure air quality, humidity, other environ parameters.
b) Connectivity: IoT devices communicate through various protocols, such as:
    - Wi-Fi: It is common in homes automation and consumer devices.
    - Bluetooth: This is ideal for short range connections (example, connecting your smartphone to a smartwatch)

- Cellular Network: It is used for remote monitoring (example, tracking shipping containers globally).
- Low Power Wide Area Network (LPWAN): This is efficient for battery powered devices (example, soil moisture sensors in agriculture).

c) Data flow and Processing:

- Edge computing: Some data processing occurs directly on the device (at the edge to reduce latency). It can handle business data and send the results to the cloud. Cloud Computing: Most data is sent to the cloud for storage, analyze and visualization.
- Fog Computing: This is a hybrid approach that combines edge and cloud resources. It cannot work by itself because it does not create data, it needs edge computing.

d) Security and Privacy:

- Authentication: This is ensuring that only authorized devices can access the network.
- Encryption and Tokenization: These are used to protect data from loss during transmission and also protect entrepreneurs against cyber-attacks threats.
- Device Management: This entails regular updates and patches to prevent vulnerabilities.
- Privacy Concerns: This involves balancing data collection with user privacy right.

Marketing Strategies Matter for Start-Ups

A marketing strategy is a plan that outlines how a start-up will reach, attract and retain its target customers. It also defines the value preposition, the competitive advantage and the marketing mix of the star-up. A marketing strategy is beneficial for start-ups because of the following reasons:

How to Create a marketing Plan and Budget

One of the most important aspects of any startup marketing strategy is how to allocate resources and measures results. Without a clear plan and budget, you may end up wasting money on ineffective or inefficient campaigns, or miss out on opportunities to grow your audience and

revenue. A marketing plan and budget should be based on your business goals, your target market, your competitive analysis and your marketing channels.

Steps to create a marketing plan and budget for your startup include:

i. Define your marketing objectives: What are the specific, measurable achievable, relevant and time-bound (SMART) goals that you want to achieve with your marketing efforts? For example, do you want to increase brand awareness, generate leads, acquire customer, retain customers or increase referrals? What are the key performance indicators (KPIs) that you will track and report on?

ii. Identify your target market: Who are your ideal customers? What are their demographics, psychographics, behavior needs, pain point and preferences? How can you reach them and communicate with them effectively? You can use tools such as customers personas, surveys, interviews and analytics, to gain insights into your target market.

iii. Conduct a competitive analysis: Who are your direct and indirect competitors? What are their strengths and weaknesses? What are their unique selling prepositions (USPs)? How do they market themselves? What are their marketing channels, tactics and budgets? How do they perform on the KPIs that you care about? You can use tools such as SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats) analysis, competitor matrix and competitor bench marking, to evaluate your competitors and identify gaps and opportunities in the market. They can also use tools such as Google trends, Similar Web, Alexa, BuzzSumo and SEMrush to find what channels and tactics their competitors are using, what content they are creating. They can jump on the innovation bandwagon rapidly and develop new solutions from the scratch. This is called niche strategy. A niche market is a segment of a larger market that can be defined its own unique needs, preferences, or identity that makes it different from the market at large (Egolum, 2023).

iv. Choose your marketing channels: based on your marketing objectives, target market and competitive analysis, what are the best channels to reach and engage your potential and existing customers? You can use tools such as the marketing mix, the customer journey map, and the channel effectiveness matrix to select and prioritize your marketing channels.

Some common marketing channels for start-ups include:

a. Website: website is online storefront and hub of your digital marketing activities. It should be user-friendly, mobile responsive, fast-loading, secure and optimized for search engine (SEO) and conservation.
b. E-mail: E-mail marketing is one of the effective and cost-efficient marketing channels for start-up. It allows one to build and nurture relationship with your subscribers, deliver personalized and timely messages and drive traffic and sales.
c. Social media: Choose the social media platforms that are most relevant and popular to increase your brand awareness, reach new audiences, generate leads and foster community and loyalty. among your target market.
d. Content marketing: This is the process of creating and distributing valuable, informative, entertaining and relevant contents to attract, educate and convert your audience. Create a content calendar that outline the topics formats channels and frequency of your content production and distribution.

Some common content formats for start-ups are:

- Blogposts: Blogposts are articles that provide in-depth and useful information to your audience on topic related to your industry, niche or product. They can help you showcase your knowledge and expertise, answer your audience's questions and solve their problem.
- E-books: E-books are longer and more comprehensive pieces of content that cover a specific topic or theme in details. They can help you demonstrate your authority and thought leadership, as well as generate leads and email subscribers.
- Videos: videos are visual and engaging pieces of content that can capture your audience attention and emotion. They can showcase your product features and benefits, tell your brand story, share customers testimonials or provide tutorials and tips conversions.
- Podcasts: Podcasts are audio pieces of content that can provide your audience with valuable and entertaining in formation, insights or stories. They can build a loyalty and engage fan base, as well as increase your brand awareness.
- Webinars: Webinars are live or recorded online presentations or workshops that can provide your audience with in-dept and interactive learning experiences. They can help you educate your audience, showcase your product or service or collaborate with other experts or influencers.

- Infographics: Infographics are visual pieces of content that can provide your audience with data, facts, or statistics in an easy-to-understand and appealing way. They can help you simplify complex or boring information, highlight key points, or compare different options or scenarios.
- Paid advertising: Paid advertising is the process of paying to display your ads on various online platforms, such as search engines, social media, websites, or apps. Paid advertising can help you increase your brand visibility, reach new and targeted audiences, generate leads and sales, and test and optimize your marketing campaigns.

Some of the common paid advertising platforms and formats for startups are:

Google Ads; Facebook Ads; Linkedin Ads; and Twitter ads. They are the largest and most popular online advertising platform that allows you to display your ads on Google's search engine results pages (SERPs), Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, LinkedIn, and Twitter. You can use paid Ads platform to target your audience based on their profile information, followers, , company, job title, behavior, et cetera.

3. What is Blockchain Technology?

Blockchain is a distributed ledger technology where each transaction is stored in a 'block' and connected to the next in a 'chain'.Since its invention in 2008, blockchain technology has revolutionized the way we transfer, store and secure data. Initially used as the foundation for Bitcoin, the world's first cryptocurrency, blockchain has since become associated with cryptocurrencies and digital money. Blockchain technology can be used to create decentralized autonomous organizations (DAOs) that are governed by a set of rules encoded into the blockchain. These DAOs can be used to manage and coordinate activities within a network of participants.It is distributed across a network of computers and is unable to be modified or altered once it is added to the ledger. This creates an immutable system of record-keeping with enhanced security, transparency and trust which can be used to store a variety of data or digital assets.

Advantages of Blockchain Technology

i. By removing the need for a third-party intermediary, blockchain-based transactions can be faster, cheaper and less prone to human error.
ii. It can be used to securely store and transfer digital assets, such as cryptocurrencies.

iii. Blockchain's decentralized system means it is more resilient to malicious attacks, making it more secure than traditional methods of record-keeping such as databases.
iv. Blockchain technology can be used to create smart contracts, which are self-executing contracts that can be used to automate processes and transactions.
v. It can be used to ensure that all parties involved in a transaction are held accountable, thereby, not only reduce the risk of fraud, but also ensure that all parties involved in a transaction are treated fairly.
vi. Block chain technology could be used to create new business models and opportunities, allowing companies like Walmart and International Business Machines (IBM) Corporation to explore new markets and create innovative products and services

Disadvantages of Block chain Technology

i. Blockchain-based transactions are not always anonymous and can be traced back to their originator.
ii. Since it is resource-intensive, it requires powerful hardware to operate efficiently.
iii. There are many security vulnerabilities that need to be addressed, as it is still new and evolving.
iv. Block chain technology is not always user-friendly, as it can be difficult to understand and use for those who are not familiar with the technology.
v. It is not always cost-effective, as the hardware and software required to run it can be expensive.

4. The Rise of EdTech Startups: Transforming Education through Entrepreneurial Ventures

In recent years, the education sector has witnessed a remarkable transformation, through the emergence of EdTech startups. These innovative companies are leveraging technology to revolutionize traditional learning methods, making education more accessible, engaging, and effective than ever before (Egolum, 2023).

EdTech Startups are entrepreneurial ventures that focus on developing and delivering technology-based solutions to enhance teaching, learning, and educational outcomes. These startups operate across various segments of the education industry, including K-12 education, higher education, corporate training, and lifelong learning.

The Impact of EdTech Startup

1. Accessibility: Through online platforms and mobile apps, these startups are making education accessible to learners worldwide, regardless of their geographical location or socioeconomic background.

2. Personalized Learning: By leveraging AI and machine learning algorithms, these startups are offering personalized learning experiences to each student's needs, learning pace, and preferences.

3. Interactive Content: They are creating, engaging and interactive educational content, videos, simulations, games, and virtual reality experiences, to make learning more enjoyable and effective.

4. Skill Development: With a focus on 21st-century skills such as critical thinking, creativity, communication, and collaboration, these startups are equipping learners with the competencies needed to succeed in the digital age.

Challenges Facing EdTech Startups

a. Access to Funding: Securing adequate funding is a common challenge for these startups, given the high development costs associated with building and scaling technology-based education.

b. Regulatory Compliance: These startups must navigate complex regulatory frameworks and compliance requirements, particularly in the highly regulated education sector.

c. User Adoption: Convincing students, parents, and educational institutions to adopt new EdTech tools and platforms, require effective marketing and user engagement strategies.

5. Green technology startups and entrepreneurship

Green technology startups, also known as Clean-Tech startups, are companies that focus on developing and implementing innovative solutions to address environmental challenges. These startups leverage technology and innovation to create sustainable alternatives in various sectors such as energy, transportation, agriculture, waste management, and more.

Benefits of Green Technology Startups

i. They play an invaluable role by reducing greenhouse gas emissions, conserving natural resources, and promoting circular economy principles to safeguard Earth's ecosystems for future generations.

ii. They rely on cutting-edge technologies like renewable energy sources (such as solar or wind power), energy-efficient appliances, electric vehicles, sustainable packaging materials and water purification systems, to create a cleaner and greener future for all.
iii. These startups also possess an entrepreneurial spirit by seeking out opportunities where sustainability intersects with market demand.
iv. Green technology startups drive innovation, by thinking outside the box and pushing boundaries, to come up with new ideas and technologies that can revolutionize industries.
v. Green technology startups also stimulate economic growth. As demand for environmentally friendly products and services increases, so does job creation in this sector.

6. The Gig Economy

The Gig economy is labor market that relies on temporary and part-time workers who are often independent contractors and freelancers rather than full-time employees. It provides some exciting opportunities for companies whose business model usually involves a smart phone app that serves a key role in two-sided markets, usually buyers and sellers, who want and will pay for a service with those who will provide a service for a fee. In fact, an app plays a key role in how these businesses function; it can make launching a new business a little easier because it takes care of many of the details that a small business would often have to do on their own, such as attracting clients, collecting fees, and compensating producers for the jobs they perform.

App-based ride-hailing businesses such as Uber and Lyft are some of the most widely known in the gig economy. Ride-hailing apps offer low **barriers to entry** because drivers use their own or rented cars to offer rides whenever they choose. These businesses offer workers true flexibility; there are no minimum hour requirements, so drivers can work as many hours they want to.

Entrepreneurs can both work in the gig economy and establish a new business at the same time. This enables them supplement their income when their new business is slow. In fact, the vast majority of Uber drivers work only 8, 12, or maybe 15 hours a week driving, using these gigs to supplement their income from their startup or another job.

7. Cyber security Ventures: Entrepreneurial Opportunities in Protecting Digital Assets.

Google Cloud's "Cyber security Forecast 2024" report, warned that cyber attackers are using AI to their advantage and that new trends in malware development are making it faster to create and

harder to detect, hence, causing serious financial and business consequences for companies. Cyber security refers to the measures that are taken to protect data and information stored on all electronic devices that are connected to the internet from the malicious attacks, hacking operations, data theft and sabotage. The volume and sophistication of cyber-attacks have grown significantly since the first computer viruses emerged in the 1970s and the Morris worm became the first major internet-based attack in 1988.Consequently, a single successful attack can have a catastrophic impact, with the potential to expose personal information, bring a company's operations to a halt, cripple critical infrastructure and even physically harm people.

Enterprise leaders in many organizations have increasingly prioritized cyber security, seeking to implement more rigorous policies, procedures and technologies to defend against cyber threats of all kinds –denial of service attacks, ransom ware attacks, phishing, malware, file less attacks, Man -in the middle attack, malicious Apps, et cetera

Why Strong Cyber security is Critical to Business Success

1. Nearly every organization requires IT systems to function, which has significantly increased the consequences of a successful cyber attack.
2. Data is now one of the most valuable assets in most companies, hence, any security issues that hurt an organization's data quality or access could affect business operations.
3. As the number of bad actors is increasing, so are the sophistication of their attacks and the access they have to the technological tools to help launch those attacks.
4. Government regulations and industry requirements mandate cyber security standards for many businesses, giving them no choice in making cyber security a priority.
5. Business opportunities are created if consumers 'demands are met, by making the necessary cyber security investments to thwart cybercriminals from stealing customer information.

8. 3D Printing in Manufacturing Entrepreneurship

3D printing, also known as additive manufacturing, is a process that uses digital design-computer aided design (CAD) to creating three-dimensional objects layer by layer by using different materials including plastic, ceramic and metal.

Role of 3D Printing in Manufacturing Entrepreneurship.

a. Faster Production: 3D printers significantly shorten prototype and production times. This allows entrepreneurs to bring their products to market faster.

b. More Flexible Production: 3D printers allow production in small batches. In this way, entrepreneurs can reduce their inventory costs and produce according to demand.

9. Space Tech Entrepreneurship: The New Frontier for Business Innovation.

The space industry is a dynamic and multifaceted domain that encompasses a wide range of activities, from satellite launches and space tourism to asteroid mining and interplanetary exploration. Understanding this landscape is crucial for aspiring space entrepreneurs who seek to navigate the cosmos and build successful ventures. key insights in space industry:

1. Commercial Space Companies and Startups:

These entities are driving innovation and expanding the boundaries. Examples include:

- SpaceX: Founded by Elon Musk, it revolutionized space access with reusable rockets like the Falcon 9. Their ambitious goal is to make humanity a multi-planetary species.
- Blue Origin: Led by Jeff Bezos, it focuses on suborbital space tourism and aims to create a future where millions live and work in space.
- Rocket Lab: It provides cost-effective for small Electron Rocket satellite launches.

2. Government Space Agencies: National space agencies play a pivotal role in shaping the industry. Examples include:

- NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration): Pioneering **space exploration**, scientific research, and international collaborations.
- ESA (European Space Agency): Collaborating on projects like the Arianne rocket family and Earth observation satellites.
- ISRO (Indian Space Research Organization): Known for its Mars Orbiter Mission and low-cost satellite launches.

3. Satellite Constellations and Connectivity: Companies like One Web, Star link, and Telesat are deploying massive satellite constellations to provide global internet coverage. These constellations promise low-latency, high-speed connectivity.

4. Space Tourism and Exploration: Virgin Galactic and Blue Origin are pioneering suborbital space tourism. Soon, civilians will experience weightlessness and see Earth from space.

- Artemis Program: NASA's initiative to return humans to the Moon and establish a sustainable presence there. Private companies will contribute to lunar exploration.
- Mars Colonization: Space X's vision of establishing a self-sustaining city on Mars.

5. Space Resources and Mining: Asteroids contain valuable resources like water, metals, and rare minerals. Companies like Planetary Resources aim to mine these celestial bodies.

6. Space Regulations and Policies: International treaties govern space activities. The Outer Space Treaty ensures peaceful use and prohibits territorial claims.

7. Emerging Technologies:

- CubeSats: Tiny satellites for research, education, and Earth observation.
- Reusable Rockets: Reducing launch costs and increasing accessibility

Conclusion

Technology has made it possible for entrepreneurs to reach new markets and customers without the need for physical presence. The gig economy supports entrepreneurship by providing entrepreneurs with opportunities to earn extra income by supplementing and smoothing the income of entrepreneurs. As the EdTech ecosystem continues to evolve, the future of education holds immense potential for personalized, interactive, and lifelong learning experiences. With the help IoT, businesses can now reach global audiences with ease. By developing new Green-technologies and practices that promote energy efficiency, renewable energy sources, waste reduction, and sustainable agriculture, these startups contribute to a more sustainable future for our planet.Space industry is a captivating blend of science, technology, entrepreneurship, and dreams. Hence, embracing entrepreneurship and adopting technovation is a proactive approach that can aid organization stay ahead of the curve and unlock new opportunities for growth and sustainability.

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CHAPTER EIGHT

ENTREPRENEURSHIP IN NIGERIA

Uzokife Georgina Chinelo and Alonta, Gabriel Chidiebere, Ph.D

The Evolution of Entrepreneurship in Nigeria

Entrepreneurship is a critical driver of economic development, innovation, and job creation globally. In Nigeria, entrepreneurship has a long and evolving history, deeply intertwined with the nation's socio-economic and cultural fabric. With a population of over 200 million, Nigeria is Africa's most populous country, presenting both vast opportunities and significant challenges for entrepreneurial ventures. Entrepreneurship in Nigeria has undergone significant transformation, influenced by various historical periods and socio-economic changes, namely:

Pre-Colonial Era

Before the advent of colonial rule, Nigerian societies were already engaged in sophisticated forms of trade and commerce. Indigenous entrepreneurial activities were primarily driven by the need for subsistence and the exchange of goods through barter systems. The Trans-Saharan trade routes played a crucial role, linking Northern Nigeria to North Africa and beyond. Kano, for instance, was a notable commercial hub, renowned for its leather and textile industries. These pre-colonial entrepreneurs managed extensive trade networks, trading goods such as gold, kola nuts, and slaves (Falola& Heaton, 2008).

Colonial Period

The colonial period introduced new dynamics to Nigerian entrepreneurship. The British colonial administration promoted the production of cash crops like cocoa, groundnuts, and palm oil for export. This period saw the rise of notable entrepreneurs who capitalized on these opportunities. Alhaji Alhassan Dantata, a prominent figure, built a fortune through the groundnut trade, becoming one of West Africa's wealthiest individuals (Barnes, 1986).The introduction of Western education and economic systems also played a significant role. Missionary schools and

colonial policies encouraged the emergence of a new class of educated Nigerians who ventured into various business activities. However, colonial policies often favored foreign businesses over indigenous entrepreneurs, creating structural barriers that persisted post-independence (Olutayo, 1999).

Post-Independence

After gaining independence in 1960, Nigeria's entrepreneurial landscape continued to evolve. The oil boom of the 1970s brought substantial wealth but also economic challenges such as corruption and mismanagement. Despite these issues, Nigerian entrepreneurs demonstrated resilience and adaptability. The structural adjustment programs (SAPs) of the 1980s and 1990s, initiated by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and World Bank, aimed to liberalize the economy, reducing state control and encouraging private enterprise (Adejugbe, 2004).These reforms opened up new opportunities in sectors such as telecommunications, banking, and manufacturing. However, they also led to significant economic hardships for many Nigerians, prompting a surge in informal sector activities as individuals sought alternative means of livelihood (Iheduru, 2002).

Modern Era

The return to democracy in 1999 marked a new chapter for Nigerian entrepreneurship. Economic reforms, increased foreign direct investment, and technological advancements have spurred growth in various sectors. The rise of tech hubs such as Yaba in Lagos has positioned Nigeria as a leader in Africa's tech ecosystem, fostering innovation and the growth of startups (Ndubuisi-Obi, 2020).Today, Nigeria boasts a dynamic entrepreneurial ecosystem characterized by a growing number of small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) and startups driving economic growth. Despite persistent challenges such as infrastructural deficits and regulatory bottlenecks, Nigerian entrepreneurs continue to thrive, leveraging opportunities in digital technology, agriculture, and creative industries (Nwankwo, 2019).

Biography of Inspirational Entrepreneurs in Nigeria

1. **Aliko Dangote (**Manufacturing and Cement**)**: Aliko Dangote, born on April 10, 1957, in Kano, Nigeria, is the founder and chairman of Dangote Group. His entrepreneurial journey began in 1978 when he received a loan from his uncle, which he used to start trading in commodities such as sugar, rice, and cement. Over the years, Dangote diversified his business interests, expanding into manufacturing and infrastructure. Dangote Cement, established in 1981, has grown to become the largest cement producer in Africa, significantly reducing the continent's reliance on imported cement. His business acumen and strategic vision have led to the conglomerate's expansion into other sectors, including food processing, freight, and oil.Dangote's businesses employ tens of thousands of people, contributing significantly to Nigeria's GDP. He is also involved in various philanthropic activities through the Aliko Dangote Foundation, focusing on health, education, and economic empowerment.

2. **Tony Elumelu**(Banking and Investment): Tony Elumelu, born on March 22, 1963, in Jos, Nigeria, is a prominent economist, entrepreneur, and philanthropist. He gained recognition after turning Standard Trust Bank into one of Nigeria's top banks, leading to its merger with United Bank for Africa (UBA), where he served as CEO. Under his leadership, UBA expanded from a single-country operation into a pan-African bank with operations in 20 African countries. Elumelu later founded Heirs Holdings, a family-owned investment company, and the Tony Elumelu Foundation, which has empowered thousands of African entrepreneurs through training, mentorship, and funding. Elumelu's advocacy for "Africapitalism" promotes the idea that African private sector investments should create economic and social wealth. His foundation's entrepreneurship program is one of the largest private-sector interventions in Africa's development.

3. **Innocent Ifediaso Chukwuma (**Innoson Motors**):** Innocent Ifediaso Chukwuma, born in Umudim, Nnewi, Anambra State, is the founder and CEO of Innoson Vehicle Manufacturing Company, Nigeria's first indigenous car manufacturer. His entrepreneurial journey began in the motorcycle spare parts trade. In 2007, Chukwuma ventured into automobile manufacturing, establishing Innoson Motors, which produces a range of vehicles, including cars, buses, and trucks. Under his leadership, Innoson Motors has significantly contributed to Nigeria's automotive industry, reducing the reliance on imported vehicles and creating numerous jobs

while providing technical training to young Nigerians. Innocent Chukwuma's success has inspired many young entrepreneurs and positioned Nigeria on the global automotive map.

4**. Cosmas Maduka (**Coscharis Group**):** Cosmas Maduka, from Nnewi, Anambra State, is the founder of Coscharis Group, a conglomerate with interests in various sectors, including automobile sales, agriculture, and information technology. Maduka's entrepreneurial journey began at a young age when he worked as an apprentice in a spare parts business. He later established his own company, Coscharis Motors, which has grown into a leading distributor of luxury vehicles in Nigeria, representing brands like BMW, Jaguar, and Ford. Maduka has also diversified his business interests into agriculture and IT, significantly contributing to Nigeria's economic diversification. His story of perseverance and innovation serves as a motivational blueprint for aspiring entrepreneurs.

5. Leo Stan Ekeh (Zinox Technologies): Leo Stan Ekeh, from Ubomiri in Imo State, is the founder and chairman of Zinox Technologies, Nigeria's leading indigenous technology company. Ekeh started his career in the office equipment business before venturing into computer manufacturing. In 2001, he founded Zinox Technologies, which produced Nigeria's first internationally certified branded computer. Zinox Technologies has been instrumental in advancing Nigeria's ICT sector, playing a key role in the computerization of Nigeria's electoral process and other national projects. Leo Stan Ekeh's contributions have significantly improved Nigeria's technological landscape, fostering innovation and digital inclusion.

6. **Allen Ifechukwu Onyema (Aviation):** Allen Ifechukwu Onyema, born in Warri, Delta State, is the founder and CEO of Air Peace, Nigeria's largest airline. Onyema began his career in law but transitioned to aviation with the establishment of Air Peace in 2013. The airline, which started with just a few domestic flights, has grown to become a significant player in the Nigerian aviation industry, offering both domestic and international flights. Air Peace has played a crucial role in improving Nigeria's connectivity and has also been involved in several humanitarian missions, such as evacuating Nigerians from South Africa during xenophobic attacks. Onyema's innovative approach to aviation and commitment to corporate social responsibility have set him apart as a leading figure in the industry.

7. Emeka Offor (Chrome Group): Emeka Offor, from Oraifite, Anambra State, is the founder and chairman of Chrome Group, a diversified conglomerate with interests in oil and gas, power, and logistics. Offor began his entrepreneurial journey in the oil and gas sector, establishing Chrome Oil Services in the 1990s. The company has since expanded into various industries, becoming a major player in Nigeria's business landscape. Chrome Group has contributed to Nigeria's energy sector through its investments in oil and gas exploration and production, and Offor's philanthropic activities include supporting education and healthcare initiatives. Emeka Offor's business success and philanthropic efforts have positively impacted many communities, promoting socio-economic development.

8. Cletus Ibeto (Ibeto Group): Cletus Ibeto, from Nnewi, Anambra State, is the founder and chairman of the Ibeto Group, a leading conglomerate in Nigeria. Ibeto started his career in the motor spare parts industry before diversifying into cement manufacturing, automotive, and petrochemicals. The Ibeto Group has become a major industrial player in Nigeria. Ibeto Cement is one of the largest cement manufacturers in Nigeria, contributing to the country's infrastructure development. The group's diversified interests include hospitality and real estate, creating numerous job opportunities. Cletus Ibeto's entrepreneurial success and industrial contributions have significantly boosted Nigeria's economy, particularly in the manufacturing sector.

9. Folorunso Alakija(Fashion and Oil): Folorunso Alakija was born on July 15, 1951, in Ikorodu, Lagos State. She began her career as a secretary at Sijuade Enterprises before venturing into the fashion industry with her label, Supreme Stitches, in 1985. The label quickly became successful, dressing Nigeria's elite and gaining national recognition. In 1993, Alakija transitioned into the oil sector, acquiring an oil prospecting license. This venture led to the establishment of Famfa Oil, which became one of Nigeria's most lucrative oil exploration companies after discovering significant oil reserves. As one of the wealthiest women in Africa, Alakija is a role model for aspiring female entrepreneurs. She is also a philanthropist, focusing on education and health through her Rose of Sharon Foundation.

10. **Mike Adenuga** (Telecommunications and Oil): Mike Adenuga, born on April 29, 1953, in Ibadan, Nigeria, is the founder of Globacom, Nigeria's second-largest telecommunications operator. Adenuga initially amassed his fortune in the oil industry with Conoil Producing

Limited, which became one of Nigeria's largest indigenous oil exploration companies. In 2003, he launched Globacom, which quickly gained a significant market share by offering competitive pricing and innovative services. Globacom's infrastructure development, including the Glo-1 submarine cable, significantly improved internet connectivity in Nigeria and West Africa.Adenuga's ventures have created thousands of jobs and contributed to technological advancement in Nigeria. He is also known for his philanthropic efforts, particularly in education and healthcare.

11. **Stella Chinyelu Okoli**: Stella Chinyelu Okoli, born in Kano, is the founder and CEO of Emzor Pharmaceutical Industries, a leading pharmaceutical company in Nigeria. Okoli's journey in entrepreneurship began with her background in pharmacy and her experience working in various healthcare institutions. She founded Emzor in 1984 with a vision to provide affordable and high-quality pharmaceuticals to Nigerians. Under her leadership, Emzor has grown into one of the largest indigenous pharmaceutical manufacturers in Nigeria, producing over 140 products. Okoli has also been a strong advocate for healthcare and pharmaceutical development in Nigeria, and her success has paved the way for many female entrepreneurs in the industry.

12. **Jason Njoku**(Digital Media and Entertainment): Jason Njoku, born on December 11, 1980, in London, United Kingdom, is the co-founder and CEO of iROKOtv. Njoku recognized the potential of Nollywood content and, along with his partner Bastian Gotter, created a platform to distribute African films globally. Launched in 2011, iROKOtv has become one of the largest online distributors of African entertainment. Njoku's vision has transformed the way Nollywood content is consumed, making it accessible to a global audience.Njoku's innovation has transformed the distribution of Nollywood films, significantly boosting the global reach of Nigerian entertainment.

13. Pascal Dozie (Diamond Bank): Pascal Dozie, from Egbu, Imo State, is the founder of Diamond Bank, one of Nigeria's leading financial institutions. Dozie started his career as an economist and business consultant. In 1990, he founded Diamond Bank, which became known for its innovative banking solutions and customer service excellence. Under his leadership, Diamond Bank grew into one of Nigeria's top banks before its merger with Access Bank in 2019. Additionally, Dozie played a significant role in the telecom industry as a founding investor in

MTN Nigeria. His visionary leadership has influenced Nigeria's banking and telecommunications sectors, promoting financial inclusion and connectivity.

Youth and Women Entrepreneurship in Nigeria

Entrepreneurship plays a pivotal role in driving economic development, fostering innovation, and creating employment opportunities. In Nigeria, the importance of youth and women entrepreneurship cannot be overstated, given the demographic realities and socio-economic challenges. Youth entrepreneurship leverages the energy, creativity, and technological savvy of young people, while women entrepreneurship addresses gender disparities and empowers women economically and socially. This chapter delves into the dynamics, challenges, and opportunities of youth and women entrepreneurship in Nigeria, highlighting their contributions to national development.

Youth Entrepreneurship in Nigeria

Youth entrepreneurship refers to the engagement of young people, typically between the ages of 18 and 35, in entrepreneurial activities. This demographic represents a significant portion of Nigeria's population, making it crucial to harness their potential for economic growth and innovation. Youth entrepreneurship not only provides a pathway to employment but also stimulates economic diversification and resilience.

Challenges Faced by Youth Entrepreneurs

1. **Access to Finance**: One of the most significant barriers for young entrepreneurs is securing capital. Traditional financial institutions are often reluctant to provide loans to young people due to perceived risks, lack of credit history, and insufficient collateral.

2. **Education and Skills**: Many young Nigerians lack the necessary entrepreneurial skills and business acumen. The formal education system often does not equip students with practical skills required for starting and managing a business.

3. **Regulatory Environment**: The regulatory framework in Nigeria can be cumbersome and intimidating for young entrepreneurs. Bureaucratic processes, high registration costs, and complex tax systems can deter new business ventures.

4. **Mentorship and Support**: Young entrepreneurs often lack access to experienced mentors and supportive networks that can provide guidance, resources, and business opportunities.

Opportunities for Youth Entrepreneurs

1. **Technology and Innovation**: The rapid advancement of technology offers numerous opportunities for young entrepreneurs to innovate and create tech-driven solutions. Sectors such as fintech, agritech, and edtech are burgeoning with potential.

2. **Government Initiatives**: Programs like the National Youth Investment Fund (NYIF) and Youth Enterprise with Innovation in Nigeria (YouWiN!) provide essential funding and support structures aimed at fostering youth entrepreneurship.

3. **Incubators and Accelerators**: Numerous incubators and accelerators, such as Co-Creation Hub (CcHub) and the Tony Elumelu Foundation, offer training, mentorship, and funding to young entrepreneurs, helping them scale their businesses.

4. **Social Media and E-commerce**: Digital platforms like Instagram, Facebook, and Jumia enable young entrepreneurs to reach broader markets and customers without the need for significant upfront capital investment.

Women Entrepreneurship in Nigeria

Women entrepreneurship involves women engaging in entrepreneurial activities, creating businesses, and driving economic growth. In Nigeria, women entrepreneurs are increasingly recognized for their contributions to economic development, despite facing significant barriers.

Challenges Faced by Women Entrepreneurs

1. **Access to Finance**: Women often find it harder to obtain loans and investment due to gender biases and lack of collateral. Financial institutions may view female entrepreneurs as higher-risk clients.

2. **Cultural Barriers**: Societal norms and expectations can restrict women's ability to start and run businesses. Gender roles often limit the time and resources women can dedicate to their enterprises.

3. **Education and Training**: Many women lack access to the necessary education and training to develop entrepreneurial skills. This gap limits their ability to effectively manage and grow their businesses.

4. **Legal and Regulatory Issues**: Discriminatory laws and practices can hinder women's entrepreneurial activities. Legal systems may not provide adequate protection or support for women business owners.

Opportunities for Women Entrepreneurs

1. **Microfinance and Cooperative Societies**: These organizations provide women with access to small loans and savings mechanisms, enabling them to start and grow businesses with limited capital.

2. **Government and NGO Programmes:** Initiatives such as the Women's Fund for Economic Empowerment (WOFEE) and Women Entrepreneurship Development Project (WEDP) offer financial support and capacity-building services.

3.**Networking and Mentorship**: Organizations like the Nigerian Association of Women Entrepreneurs (NAWE) provide networking opportunities, mentorship, and advocacy for women entrepreneurs.

4. **E-commerce and Social Media**: Digital platforms enable women to start and grow businesses with lower overhead costs. Social media allows for effective marketing and customer engagement.

Entrepreneurship Support Institutions in Nigeria

Entrepreneurship support institutions play a crucial role in fostering and nurturing entrepreneurial ventures by providing essential resources, mentorship, training, and financial assistance. These institutions include government agencies, private organizations, non-profits, and educational institutions. In Nigeria, various support structures have been established to help entrepreneurs navigate the challenges of starting and growing their businesses. This section provides an in-depth look at key entrepreneurship support institutions in Nigeria, highlighting their roles, programmes, and impact on the entrepreneurial ecosystem.

Key Entrepreneurship Support Institutions

1. **Bank of Industry (BoI)**: The Bank of Industry is one of Nigeria's leading development finance institutions, dedicated to providing financial support for industrial and entrepreneurial ventures. The BoI has significantly contributed to the growth of various industries in Nigeria by providing financial assistance to thousands of businesses, thereby creating jobs and fostering economic development. Part of its programmes and servicesinclude:Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises Development Fund (MSMEDF), Youth Entrepreneurship Support (YES) Programme, BOI Gender Desk, and so on.

2. **Small and Medium Enterprises Development Agency of Nigeria (SMEDAN)**: SMEDAN is a government agency established to promote the development of micro, small, and medium enterprises in Nigeria.SMEDAN has been instrumental in improving the business environment for MSMEs, enhancing their productivity, and increasing their contribution to the economy. SMEDAN is known for the following programmes and services:Business Development Services (BDS), National Enterprises Development Programme (NEDEP), SME Clinics, etc.

3. **Tony Elumelu Foundation (TEF)**: The Tony Elumelu Foundation is a private, non-profit organization focused on empowering African entrepreneurs. Since its inception, the TEF Entrepreneurship Programme has supported thousands of entrepreneurs, creating jobs and promoting economic growth across the continent. The foundation is associated with these activities: TEF Entrepreneurship Programme andTEFConnect

4. **Co-Creation Hub (CcHub)**: CcHub is Nigeria’s first open living lab and pre-incubation space designed to accelerate the application of social capital and technology for economic prosperity. CcHub has been pivotal in nurturing tech startups in Nigeria, helping them scale and become sustainable businesses that address social issues. It has the following programmes and Services: Incubation Programme, CcHub Design Lab and Tech-In Series.

5. **Lagos State Employment Trust Fund (LSETF)**: LSETF is a government initiative aimed at tackling unemployment by supporting entrepreneurship and small businesses in Lagos State. LSETF has empowered numerous entrepreneurs and small businesses in Lagos, contributing to job creation and economic growth in the state. Part of the activities include but not limited to providing affordable loans to MSMEs and entrepreneurs to support their business operations and

expansion;offering vocational training and entrepreneurial skills development programmes; supporting tech startups through workspace vouchers, access to funding, and mentorship, etc.

6. **Fate Foundation**: Fate Foundation is a non-profit organization focused on promoting entrepreneurship and business education in Nigeria. Fate Foundation has played a crucial role in building the entrepreneurial capacity of Nigerians, helping them start and grow successful businesses. It performs the following activities: Aspiring Entrepreneurs Programme (AEP), Emerging Entrepreneurs Programme (EEP) and Business Incubation Programme.

7. **Nigerian Association of Chambers of Commerce, Industry, Mines, and Agriculture (NACCIMA)**: NACCIMA is a non-profit organization that advocates for the interests of businesses in Nigeria, providing a platform for networking and policy dialogue.NACCIMA has been a strong advocate for the private sector, influencing policies that benefit entrepreneurs and contributing to the growth of the business community in Nigeria. The organization is known for: Business Advocacy, Trade Missions and Exhibitions and Capacity Building Programmes

Youth Enterprise Networks in Nigeria

Youth enterprise networks are essential platforms that foster collaboration, mentorship, and resource sharing among young entrepreneurs. These networks provide support structures that are critical for business development, innovation, and sustainability. In Nigeria, where youth unemployment is a significant issue, these networks play a vital role in creating opportunities and nurturing entrepreneurial talent. This section explores key youth enterprise networks in Nigeria, detailing their objectives, activities, and impact on the entrepreneurial landscape.

Key Youth Enterprise Networks

1. **Young Entrepreneurs of Nigeria (YEN)**: YEN aims to empower young Nigerian entrepreneurs by providing them with the necessary tools, resources, and networks to succeed. YEN has helped numerous young Nigerians start and grow their businesses by providing essential training, mentorship, and networking opportunities. The network has fostered a supportive community that encourages innovation and collaboration among young entrepreneurs.

Activities:Training and Workshops, Mentorship Programmes and Networking Events.

2. **Junior Achievement Nigeria (JAN)**: JAN is dedicated to inspiring and preparing young people to succeed in a global economy through entrepreneurship education and training. JAN has reached thousands of young Nigerians, equipping them with entrepreneurial skills and fostering a spirit of innovation and leadership. The organization's programs have led to the creation of many student-run businesses and have inspired participants to pursue entrepreneurial careers.

Activities: Company Programme, Innovation Camps, and Leadership Programmes

3. **Global Entrepreneurship Network Nigeria (GEN Nigeria)**: GEN Nigeria aims to promote entrepreneurship by connecting entrepreneurs, investors, policymakers, researchers, and support organizations. GEN Nigeria has significantly contributed to the visibility and support of entrepreneurship in Nigeria. By connecting various stakeholders, GEN Nigeria has created a robust ecosystem that supports the growth and development of young entrepreneurs.

Activities:Global Entrepreneurship Week (GEW), Startup Huddle and Ecosystem Mapping

4. **Youth Enterprise with Innovation in Nigeria (YouWiN!)**: YouWiN! aims to encourage and support youth entrepreneurship by providing financial support and business training. YouWiN! has empowered numerous young Nigerians by providing them with the necessary resources and support to start and grow their businesses. The program has created jobs and contributed to economic development by supporting innovative and viable business ideas.

Activities: Business Plan Competition, Training and Capacity Building and Mentorship and Networking.

5. **Enterprise Development Centre (EDC) of the Pan-Atlantic University**: EDC aims to support and develop entrepreneurs by providing training, mentoring, and access to networks and resources. EDC has played a critical role in nurturing the entrepreneurial spirit among young Nigerians. Through its comprehensive support programs, EDC has helped numerous entrepreneurs overcome challenges and achieve business success.

Activities: Training Programmes, Business Clinics and Networking Events.

6. **Fate Foundation's Aspiring Entrepreneurs Programme (AEP)**: The Aspiring Entrepreneurs Programme is designed to help early-stage entrepreneurs develop their business

ideas and gain practical skills to succeed. The AEP has helped many young Nigerians transform their business ideas into viable enterprises. The program's comprehensive approach ensures that participants receive the necessary skills, knowledge, and support to thrive in the entrepreneurial landscape.

Activities: Business Incubation, Workshops and Seminars and Mentorship Programme.

7. **Nigerian Youth Chamber of Commerce (NYCC)**: NYCC aims to promote youth entrepreneurship and economic empowerment by providing support and advocacy for young entrepreneurs. NYCC has been instrumental in advocating for policies that support youth entrepreneurship. Through its various programs, the chamber has empowered young entrepreneurs and contributed to economic development in Nigeria.

Activities: Advocacy, Capacity Building and Networking and Collaboration.

Environmental and Cultural Barriers to Entrepreneurship in Nigeria

Entrepreneurship in Nigeria, while vibrant and dynamic, faces several environmental and cultural barriers that can impede the establishment, growth, and sustainability of businesses. These barriers stem from socio-economic, infrastructural, and cultural factors that collectively pose significant challenges for entrepreneurs. Understanding these barriers is crucial for devising strategies to mitigate their effects and promote a more conducive environment for entrepreneurial activities.

Environmental Barriers

1. **Inadequate Infrastructure**

i**. Power Supply**: One of the most significant barriers is the unreliable power supply. Frequent power outages increase operational costs as businesses often rely on generators, which are expensive to maintain.

ii.**Transportation**: Poor transportation infrastructure, including inadequate roads and congested ports, hampers the efficient movement of goods and services. This affects supply chains and increases the cost of doing business.

iii.**Water and Sanitation**: Access to clean water and proper sanitation facilities is still a challenge in many areas, impacting businesses, especially those in the food and beverage industry.

iv.**Communication Networks**: While there has been significant improvement, inadequate and unreliable internet and communication networks can hinder business operations, especially for tech-based startups.

2. **Access to Finance**

i**. Limited Funding Opportunities**: Many entrepreneurs struggle to secure funding due to stringent lending criteria, high-interest rates, and a lack of collateral.

ii**.Venture Capital and Angel Investors**: The venture capital market is underdeveloped, and there are limited angel investors, making it difficult for startups to obtain seed funding.

iii**.Microfinance Institutions**: Although microfinance institutions exist, their reach is limited, and their interest rates can be prohibitively high.

3. **Regulatory and Bureaucratic Challenges**

i.Complex Regulatory Environment: The business regulatory environment can be complex and cumbersome, with multiple procedures required to register and run a business.

ii.Corruption: Corruption remains a pervasive issue, with businesses often required to pay bribes to expedite processes or secure contracts.

iii.Taxation: The tax system can be onerous, with multiple taxes imposed by federal, state, and local governments, creating a heavy burden for entrepreneurs.

Cultural Barriers

1. **Societal Attitudes Towards Entrepreneurship**

i. Risk Aversion: There is a prevalent risk-averse culture, where failure is stigmatized, discouraging many from pursuing entrepreneurial ventures.

ii.Preference for Traditional Employment: Societal preference for stable, traditional employment over entrepreneurial pursuits can deter individuals from starting their own businesses.

iii.Family Expectations: Family expectations, particularly the pressure to pursue certain professions (e.g., medicine, law), can discourage entrepreneurial aspirations.

2. **Gender Norms and Discrimination**

i.Gender Roles: Cultural norms often dictate gender roles, limiting women's participation in entrepreneurial activities. Women may face additional barriers such as lack of access to education and resources.

ii.Discrimination: Gender discrimination can manifest in various forms, from biased lending practices to societal attitudes that undermine women's capabilities as entrepreneurs.

iii.Balancing Roles: Women entrepreneurs often struggle to balance business responsibilities with traditional roles of caregiving and household management.

3. **Education and Skill Gaps**

i.**Educational System**: The educational system in Nigeria does not adequately prepare students for entrepreneurship. There is a lack of emphasis on entrepreneurial skills and mindset development.

ii.**Vocational Training**: Limited access to vocational training and practical skill development programs hinders the ability of potential entrepreneurs to acquire the necessary skills to start and run a business.

iii.**Innovation and Creativity**: Cultural attitudes that do not encourage questioning, creativity, and innovation can stifle entrepreneurial thinking and innovation.

4. **Networking and Mentorship**

i.**Lack of Networks**: Effective entrepreneurial networks are essential for knowledge sharing, mentorship, and support. However, many entrepreneurs lack access to such networks.

ii.**Mentorship Opportunities**: There is a shortage of mentorship programs and experienced mentors who can guide new entrepreneurs through the challenges of starting and growing a business.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurship in Nigeria is a dynamic and evolving field, deeply rooted in the nation's history and cultural diversity. The introduction of entrepreneurship education by the NUC represents a significant step towards fostering an entrepreneurial mindset among Nigerian youths. The chapter also focused on biographies of notable entrepreneurs in Nigeria with special focus on their journey, challenges, and impact. Since youth and women entrepreneurship are critical drivers of economic development in Nigeria, this chapter also addressed the unique challenges faced by these groups. Furthermore, government policies, institutional support, and targeted programmes play vital roles in creating an enabling environment for these entrepreneurs. Entrepreneurship support institutions in Nigeria are essential in fostering a thriving entrepreneurial ecosystem becausethey provide the necessary resources, training, mentorship, and financial support to help entrepreneurs overcome challenges and succeed. Finally, this chapter also looked at how environmental and cultural barriers pose significant challenges to entrepreneurship in Nigeria. Addressing these barriers requires concerted efforts from the government, private sector, and civil society to create a more supportive environment for entrepreneurs.

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CHAPTER NINE

BASIC PRINCIPLES OF E-COMMERCE

Dr. Obinna C. Ojiaku and Promise I. Ebizie

Introduction

Entrepreneurship has been a key factor in many economic innovations and advancements. Entrepreneurs, with their foresight, creativity, and willingness to take risks, have changed markets and industries. They find market gaps, create new solutions, and introduce new products and services. With the rise of the internet and digital technologies, electronic commerce (e-commerce) has become a new way of doing business, creating a new form of entrepreneurship that uses the power of the digital world.

E-commerce is the buying and selling of goods and services over the internet. It has changed how businesses operate and how consumers shop. Entrepreneurs can now easily reach a global audience, breaking down traditional geographic barriers. This shift has been supported by the widespread use of smartphones, high-speed internet, and digital payment systems. The convenience and accessibility of e-commerce have made it a key part of modern business strategy. Entrepreneurs who use e-commerce can access new markets and customer bases that were previously out of reach.

Integrating e-commerce into businesses has significant effects for both new and established companies. For startups, e-commerce offers a way to launch products without needing a physical store, reducing initial costs. Established businesses can use e-commerce to reach more customers, improve customer engagement, and streamline operations. However, moving to e-commerce comes with challenges. Entrepreneurs must handle issues like cyber security, digital marketing, and online customer service. They also need to keep up with rapidly changing technologies and consumer preferences. Despite these challenges, the potential benefits of using e-commerce in a business model are huge.

Definition and Scope of E-Commerce

There is increasing interest in using e-commerce for business transactions over the internet. Recently, the term ‘e-commerce’ is used worldwide. People define e-commerce in many ways, but generally, it means buying and selling goods and services online. Instead of going to a physical store, customers can shop from home. This includes buying physical products, digital services, and making electronic transactions. Bananda and Nwagwu (2021) defined E-commerce

as the process of buying, selling, transferring or exchanging products, service, and/ or information through the internet. E-commerce covers many activities like online shopping, electronic payments, booking tickets online, online auctions, and digital marketing. It can be done using computers, tablets, smartphones, and other smart devices. E-commerce allows businesses to operate 24/7, reach customers globally, and lower costs. It also offers consumers the convenience of shopping anytime, access to more products, and easy price comparisons.

E-commerce not only involves buying and selling online but also the processes to deliver goods to customers. This includes getting inventory from suppliers, picking and packing orders, labeling packages, and shipping them. It continues with tracking shipments, handling returns, and managing customer service related to shipping. Efficient e-commerce shipping ensures timely delivery and good condition of products, which is crucial for customer satisfaction and business success.

An E-Distinction

Many often may use the terms e-Business and e- Commerce interchangeably, but to do so would be incorrect. E-Commerce is in fact a subset of e-Business. E-Business is a term which encompasses any form of business, or transactions, conducted online.

Evolution of Ecommerce

The evolution of e-commerce can be traced back to the late 20th century when the advent of the internet and digital communication technologies began to transform business operations. Globally, the first wave of e-commerce was characterized by the emergence of online marketplaces like Amazon and eBay in the 1990s. These platforms revolutionized retail by offering consumers a new way to shop and businesses a new way to reach customers. In Nigeria, the e-commerce landscape began to take shape in the early 2000s, driven by increased internet penetration and mobile phone usage. Key players like Jumia and Konga emerged as dominant forces in the Nigerian e-commerce market, offering a wide range of products and services to consumers. Despite challenges such as inadequate infrastructure and regulatory hurdles, e-commerce in Nigeria continues to grow, driven by a young, tech-savvy population and increasing investor interest. The Nigerian e-commerce market is expected to grow from USD 7.63 billion in 2023 to USD 13.34 billion by 2028 (Mark, 2023)

E-Commerce Models

One way to classify e-commerce is by looking at the parties involved in the transaction. Different types of e-commerce include:

Business-to-Business (B2B): This is when companies sell products, services, or information to other businesses. These deals often involve large quantities and longer sales cycles. Examples

include manufacturers selling to wholesalers or wholesalers selling to retailers. B2B platforms often feature bulk ordering and special pricing.

Business-to-Consumer (B2C): This is the most common type of e-commerce, where companies sell products or services directly to consumers. It involves smaller orders and quicker sales cycles. B2C platforms focus on user experience, easy navigation, and smooth checkout processes. Examples include Amazon, Jumia, and Aliexpress.

Consumer-to-Consumer (C2C): In this model, consumers sell products or services to other consumers through an online marketplace. The marketplace connects buyers and sellers and makes money by charging a fee. Examples include eBay and Facebook Marketplace.

Consumer-to-Business (C2B): Here, consumers offer products or services to businesses in exchange for payment. This includes freelance work and influencer partnerships. Platforms like Upwork connect freelancers with businesses looking for specific services.

Business-to-Government (B2G): Businesses provide goods or services to government agencies, often through formal bidding processes and long-term contracts. This can include anything from office supplies to large infrastructure projects.

Government-to-Business (G2B): Governments sell products, services, or information to businesses. This can include public records, licenses, and tax filing services. Dedicated government portals facilitate these transactions.

Government-to-Consumer (G2C): Governments provide services or information directly to citizens. This includes online tax filing, renewing driver's licenses, and accessing public services like healthcare and education.

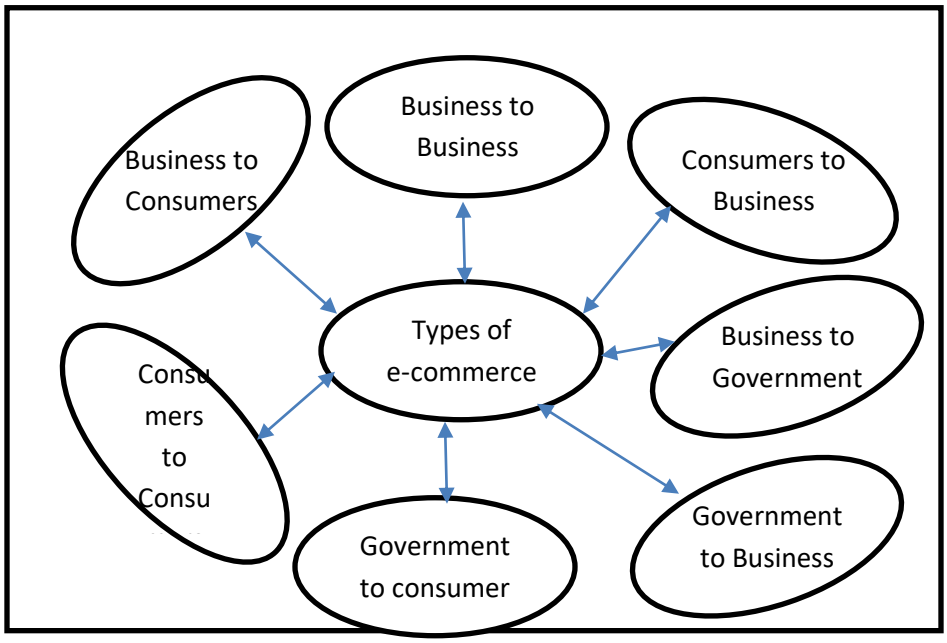


Fig.1: Schematic illustration of the Types of the E-commerce

Features of E-Commerce Technology

E-commerce improves business communication and data exchange, which are crucial for any business. The quality and quantity of information a company provides to customers or uses for decision-making can greatly impact its competitiveness. Many companies use electronic tools like computers, word processors, couriers, fax machines, telex services, cell phones, and pagers to meet their information and communication needs. However, these tools often do not meet the fast-paced demands of modern business and can create obstacles.

For example, postal services can delay information for days or weeks, overnight couriers are faster but expensive, and traditional telex and fax services are quick but costly. Communicating by phone can become a game of tag, wasting time. E-commerce addresses these issues by offering fast, cost-effective, and easy-to-use communication solutions. It leads to better transactions and wider market coverage due to its speed, convenience, and efficiency. E-commerce provides benefits such as high profit margins, instant customer relations, no loss of customers, and better control, all at a fraction of the cost of traditional methods.

Using electronic operations for commercial activities means better business solutions. It allows companies to make better decisions and send and receive important information like sales forecasts and prices instantly. Businesses will always have the information they need faster and more completely. This gives companies an edge over competitors by allowing them to inform, follow up, and request information from customers more efficiently. Additionally, it enables better control of operations, whether at work, home, or while traveling, by allowing instant communication with any business partner or firm anywhere.

SEVEN UNIQUE FEATURES OF E-COMMERCE TECHNOLOGY	
Dimension of E-commerce Technology	**Significance in Business**
Ubiquity Internet/Web technology is available everywhere: at work, at home, and elsewhere via mobile devices, anytime.	The marketplace is extended beyond traditional boundaries and is removed from a temporal and geographic location. "Marketspace" is created; shopping can take place anywhere. Customer convenience is enhanced, and shopping costs are reduced.
Global Reach The technology reaches across national boundaries, around the earth.	Commerce is enabled across cultural and national boundaries seamlessly and without modification. "Marketspace" includes potentially billions of consumers and

	millions of businesses worldwide.
Universal Standards There is one set of technology standards, namely internet standards.	There is one set of technical media standards across the globe.
Richness Video, audio, and text messages are possible.	Video, audio, and text marketing messages are integrated into a single marketing message and consuming experience.
Interactivity The technology works through interaction with the users.	Consumers are engaged in a dialog that dynamically adjusts the experience to the individual and makes the consumer a co participant in the process of delivering goods to the market.
Information Density The technology reduces information costs	Information processing, storage, and communication costs drop dramatically, while currency, accuracy, and timeliness

Source: Khurana (n.d)

Activities and Functions in E-Commerce

Advertising and Shopping: This includes searching for and browsing products online, using tools that help buyers and sellers, sending and responding to electronic requests for proposals (RFPs), advertising products and services, and navigating online services. One major challenge is the time and cost of finding and maintaining relevant information given the vast amount of data available online.

Negotiating: Buyers and sellers may negotiate transaction terms such as delivery, refund policies, credit arrangements, and usage rights. These terms can be standardized for routine use or customized for unique situations. Established business partners may have pre-negotiated terms for future exchanges.

Ordering: Buyers issue an order that outlines the quantity, price, and terms of the transaction. This order, which can be verbal, written, or electronic, usually includes an acknowledgment to prevent future disputes. In some cases, the entire transaction starts at this stage, bypassing advertising, shopping, and negotiating.

Billing: After delivering goods or services, the seller sends a bill to the buyer. This bill usually includes payment instructions. Sometimes payment is required in advance, or it is authorized upon delivery confirmation.

Payment and Settlement: The buyer sends an electronic payment, often with remittance information, to the seller. This payment may be for a single item, usage basis, or multiple items. Settlement occurs when the seller or their agent accepts the payment as valid.

Distribution and Receipt: The seller arranges for delivery of goods or services to the buyer, who then provides proof of receipt. Return policies should be agreed upon beforehand. Complex orders may involve multiple parties and require coordinated distribution strategies.

Accounting: Both buyer and seller must update their accounting records to reflect the transaction. This includes reconciling accounts receivable and payable, inventory information, and other accounting systems. Third parties may be involved if accounting services are outsourced.

Customer Service: This involves providing transaction updates, resolving issues, handling returns and refunds, offering expert advice on products and services, managing cash, and collecting delinquent payments. A well-developed customer service framework is essential for a strong e-commerce infrastructure.

Drivers of E_Commerce

E-commerce has become a major player in global retail, significantly changing how businesses operate and how consumers shop. Several key factors have driven the rapid growth and development of e-commerce:

Internet Penetration and Smartphone Adoption: The growth of e-commerce has been largely driven by the widespread use of the internet and advances in connectivity. The increase in internet usage, especially due to more accessible and affordable smartphones, has made online shopping more accessible. As more people gain internet access and data costs decrease, the potential market for e-commerce expands.

Changing Consumer Preferences: Consumers now prefer the convenience, variety, and competitive pricing offered by online retailers. The ability to compare products, read reviews, and access a wider range of goods attracts consumers to e-commerce platforms. Shopping from home saves time and effort, and online platforms often offer better deals and discounts. The need for contactless transactions and home deliveries has also made e-commerce essential. Consumers' preference for cashless payments further boosts the e-commerce sector.

Pandemic Acceleration: The COVID-19 pandemic accelerated the adoption of e-commerce as lockdowns and social distancing measures forced consumers and businesses to rely on online methods for buying and selling. Traditional brick-and-mortar businesses had to create an online presence. The shift to e-commerce for necessities like food, clothing, and electronics has permanently changed consumer behavior, and digital transformation has accelerated across all industries. The pandemic forced businesses to innovate quickly, adopting new technologies to handle increased online demand.

Logistics and Fulfillment: Advances in logistics and fulfillment services have been crucial for e-commerce growth. Effective warehousing solutions ensure that products are available and stored properly when orders come in. Modern inventory management systems help businesses track stock levels in real-time, reducing the risk of stock-outs or overstocking. Reliable shipping options, including same-day or next-day delivery, have greatly improved the customer

experience. Technology in logistics, such as GPS tracking and automated sorting systems, has increased delivery accuracy and speed.

Better Payment Systems: The development of electronic payment methods has boosted Nigeria's e-commerce sector. Various payment options, including mobile money, electronic bank transfers, and fintech developments, have made online payments easier for customers. The Central Bank of Nigeria's cashless policy and fintech initiatives have also supported this trend. Convenient and secure payment options increase customer confidence and trust, encouraging online shopping.

Social Media: Social media platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter are essential tools for e-commerce. Businesses use these platforms to advertise their products with visually appealing content that attracts potential customers. Targeted advertising on social media allows businesses to reach specific demographics based on interests, location, and online behavior. Social media enables direct interaction between businesses and customers, building a sense of community and trust. Influencers and celebrities often promote products, leveraging their large follower base to drive sales. Features like Instagram Shopping and Facebook Marketplace facilitate direct purchasing, making the buying process seamless and convenient.

Marketing: Marketing is crucial for driving e-commerce by increasing visibility and attracting customers. Search Engine Optimization (SEO) helps e-commerce websites rank higher in search results, bringing in organic traffic. Email marketing keeps customers engaged and informed about promotions, leading to repeat purchases. Social media advertising targets specific demographics, increasing brand awareness and driving sales. Content marketing provides valuable information, building trust and encouraging purchases. Influencer marketing leverages popular figures to promote products, expanding the customer base. A well-rounded marketing strategy ensures consistent traffic, customer retention, and e-commerce success.

E-Commerce Opportunities in Nigeria

E-commerce in Nigeria offers many opportunities for economic growth and development. Here are some key opportunities with examples:

Increased Sales and Market Reach: Nigerian businesses can significantly increase their sales and reach more customers through e-commerce. Unlike traditional stores, online platforms allow businesses to connect with customers beyond their local area. With more Nigerians using the internet and smartphones, online shopping is becoming more popular, leading to higher sales. The digital revolution also enables small businesses to compete with larger ones online. Online stores are open 24/7, unlike traditional stores with fixed hours, providing constant sales opportunities. These factors create a stable environment for Nigerian businesses to expand their markets and increase revenue.

Job Creation and Economic Growth: The growth of e-commerce in Nigeria has a significant impact on job creation and economic development. The industry creates various job opportunities in customer service, logistics, IT, and web development. As e-commerce platforms grow, they need more staff to handle customer inquiries, manage operations, and ensure timely

product delivery. For instance, the rise of e-commerce platforms like Konga has created many jobs in logistics, customer service, IT, and sales. This job creation helps reduce unemployment rates in Nigeria, contributing to economic stability. E-commerce also supports related industries like digital marketing, online payment systems, and cybersecurity, promoting employment growth and economic diversification.

Competitive Advantage: E-commerce gives Nigerian businesses a competitive edge in the digital age. Online sales allow businesses to reduce overhead costs, offer better prices to customers, and streamline operations. E-commerce platforms help businesses collect and analyze data on customer preferences and purchase behavior, enabling targeted marketing and personalized shopping experiences. This data-driven approach allows businesses to stay ahead of competitors by quickly adapting to market trends and consumer demands. Having an online presence also enhances a company's brand image and market position.

Access to Global Markets: E-commerce provides Nigerian businesses with opportunities to reach international markets. Local companies can attract foreign customers through online channels without having a physical presence abroad. This global reach allows businesses to expand beyond the local market and significantly increase their sales potential. Exporting goods online also generates foreign exchange and boosts Nigeria's economy. International trade through e-commerce can foster partnerships with global companies and investors, providing access to new resources and technologies.

Diverse Market Opportunities: Nigeria's diverse population offers a wide range of consumer preferences and demands, creating opportunities for niche markets and specialized e-commerce platforms. Businesses can focus on local crafts, traditional clothing, organic products, or regional cuisines. Catering to specific tastes and needs allows e-commerce companies to differentiate themselves and build a loyal customer base. Understanding and respecting cultural differences in marketing and product offerings can further enhance acceptance and popularity.

Challenges of E-Commerce

Internet Connectivity: Nigeria faces a major issue with unreliable internet in many regions. E-commerce relies heavily on good internet access, but internet use is still low in the country. Many areas lack high-speed internet, which affects people's ability to shop online. Slow and inconsistent connections can frustrate shoppers, leading them to abandon their purchases. This limits the reach and growth potential of e-commerce businesses.

Inadequate Infrastructure: Poor infrastructure in Nigeria is a major barrier to e-commerce. Bad road networks make it difficult to deliver goods to customers on time. This causes delays and higher delivery costs, especially in rural areas with impassable roads. The lack of effective warehouse management systems complicates storing and distributing goods. These infrastructure issues hinder e-commerce growth, making it hard for businesses to provide reliable and timely services to their customers.

Payment Systems: Payment methods are another challenge for e-commerce in Nigeria. Many Nigerians are wary of online payments due to security and fraud concerns. Additionally, not everyone has access to debit or credit cards, which are commonly used for online shopping. Alternative payment methods can be difficult and confusing, deterring people from completing their online transactions. The lack of accessible and trusted payment options is a major obstacle to the growth of e-commerce in the country.

Economic Challenges: Economic factors like inflation and fluctuating exchange rates also impact e-commerce in Nigeria. These factors can affect the prices of goods and services, making it hard for businesses to keep prices stable. Unstable exchange rates can lead to high import costs, raising the price of goods and making them more expensive for consumers. The current economic situation may discourage businesses and customers from fully embracing e-commerce.

Low-Quality Products: Low-quality products are a significant challenge in e-commerce, affecting customer satisfaction and brand reputation. When customers receive poor-quality products, they are likely to leave negative reviews, request refunds, and share their bad experiences with others, damaging the brand's image. This can lead to a competitive disadvantage; as unhappy customers may turn to competitors for better quality. Ensuring product quality involves thorough supplier checks and strict quality control standards. Ignoring these issues can result in lost revenue and a tarnished reputation, making it hard for businesses to retain and attract customers.

Technology Skepticism: Skepticism towards technology is a significant challenge for e-commerce in Nigeria. Many potential customers and businesses are hesitant to adopt online shopping due to concerns over security, privacy, and the reliability of online platforms. This lack of trust can deter people from making online transactions, affecting the growth of e-commerce. Additionally, unfamiliarity with digital tools and fear of cyber threats contribute to this skepticism.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical consideration in E-commerce in Nigeria

E-commerce in Nigeria has grown significantly over the past ten years, offering consumers unmatched convenience and access to a wide range of products and services. However, this growth has also brought about various ethical challenges that need to be addressed to ensure the sustainability and trustworthiness of the e-commerce sector. These ethical issues are crucial for maintaining consumer confidence and promoting fair business practices. Key concerns include data privacy, product authenticity, fair pricing, consumer protection, and transparency in business operations. Addressing these issues is essential for fostering a trustworthy e-commerce environment in Nigeria.

Data Privacy: A major ethical issue in Nigerian e-commerce is data privacy. E-commerce platforms collect large amounts of personal data, such as names, addresses, payment information, and browsing preferences. It is crucial to keep this data safe from misuse and unauthorized access. Businesses must have strong cybersecurity measures in place and follow data protection

laws to protect customer information. Being transparent about data collection practices and getting explicit consent from users is also essential for maintaining trust.

Product Authenticity: The authenticity of goods sold on online platforms is another significant ethical concern. Consumers often risk buying counterfeit or low-quality products, leading to dissatisfaction and a loss of trust in online shopping. E-commerce businesses must verify the legitimacy of the products they list and ensure that sellers meet quality standards. Strict verification procedures, guarantees, and return policies can help mitigate this issue.

Transparency: Ethical e-commerce practices rely on transparency in business operations. This means providing honest reviews and ratings, accurate product descriptions, and clear terms and conditions. Businesses should avoid misleading advertising and ensure that all information provided to customers is accurate and up-to-date. Transparency builds long-term trust with customers and fosters a sense of accountability, which is crucial for the success of e-commerce businesses.

Consumer Protection: Consumer protection is a critical ethical factor in e-commerce. Consumers must have clear information about their rights, including return and refund policies, warranty conditions, and dispute resolution processes. E-commerce platforms should offer comprehensive customer support to resolve issues promptly and fairly. Strong consumer protection laws can foster trust and encourage more people to shop online.

Ethical Marketing: Using ethical marketing practices is essential to avoid misleading or manipulating customers. Online businesses should ensure that their advertisements are truthful and do not exploit vulnerable groups such as children or the elderly. Influencer marketing, a popular strategy in Nigeria, should be transparent, with clear disclaimers about sponsored endorsements. Respecting customer privacy and avoiding intrusive ads are also part of ethical marketing. By adhering to ethical marketing principles, e-commerce companies can build lasting relationships with their customers based on honesty and trust.

Environmental Responsibilities: The environmental impact of e-commerce is growing along with the sector. Ethical considerations include reducing waste, promoting sustainable practices, and minimizing an organization’s carbon footprint. E-commerce companies should encourage recycling and reuse, use efficient logistics to reduce emissions, and adopt eco-friendly packaging. Promoting sustainable products and partnering with suppliers who follow environmental standards can also make a significant difference. By prioritizing environmental responsibility, e-commerce businesses can support global efforts to combat climate change and protect natural resources.

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CHAPTER TEN

ENTERPRISE NETWORKING

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Introduction

This chapter explores the importance of enterprise networking in business and entrepreneurship, discussing its various aspects, benefits, and strategies. It highlights the significance of building and maintaining a strong network for career growth and fostering meaningful relationships, sharing knowledge, and creating opportunities.

Entrepreneurship is a lifelong career, with no clear career path. Wang and Chugh (2014) highlight the diverse nature of entrepreneurial opportunities, requiring unique skills for launching and expanding a business. Entrepreneurs can choose from buying an established company, joining a franchise, or developing a unique concept. The benefits of entrepreneurship align with the effort put into the business, and entrepreneurs must possess the right skills. Aspiring entrepreneurs can network and advertise their ideas through associations and professional organizations, utilizing technology to create communities. The latest technologies streamline tasks like job scheduling, billing, production scheduling, and shipping, enhancing administration efficiency. They enable online exchange of customer information, generating work orders for manufacturing departments based on shipping dates. Jeffrey (1996) highlights the importance of enterprise networking in automating processes like raw materials purchasing, press scheduling, and billing, thereby reducing human error and facilitating career growth for technology entrepreneurs.

Enterprise Networking Concepts

Information dependence is increasing in enterprises, impacting profitability. Technology advancements focus on service dependability, security, and readiness to integrate new standards and systems. Networking is crucial for entrepreneurs as it fosters opportunities, builds trust, and fosters relationships within the business community, promoting innovation and growth. An enterprise network consists of physical and virtual networks and protocols that serve the dual purpose of connecting all users and systems on a local area network (LAN) and applications in the data center and cloud as well as facilitating access to network data analytics. Enterprise

networking involves a complex system of key components, including servers, switches, and routers, that work together to create a robust and efficient network infrastructure. Understanding these components is crucial for businesses seeking to leverage technology for growth and success.

Enterprise Networking New technologies, Innovations and Trends

New technologies like Secure Access Service Edge and 5G connectivity offer enhanced security and high data transmission rates, while Wi-Fi 6 and 6E provide faster speeds. Cloud-managed adoption continues, enhancing enterprise networking capabilities. A computer network used for personal or non-commercial purposes that links systems within a small room or same building or on the same campus is called a local area network (LAN). Local area networks (LANs) are pivotal for day-to-day operations within localized settings. It can be set up remotely or logically inside a bigger network. Ethernet is usually used for transmission, and quicker connections are required for higher bandwidth.

When analyzing network traffic in an enterprise setting, network administrators take growing online usage and future business strategies into account. They assess when to expand bandwidth while preserving current networks. In its most basic form, a local area network (LAN) is a way to connect several electronic devices such as microcomputers, word processors, telex terminals, printers, OCR machines and auxiliary storage over a limited geographic area using coaxial or fiber connection. Each device may communicate with another via the LAN to accomplish a particular task. For example, a word processor could contact a remote printer and instruct it to print the text sent to it. The comparatively short transmission distances contribute to higher efficiency and fast speed. Wide Area Networks (WANS) differ from Local Area Networks (LANs) in terms of protocols and components used for data transmission. WANs use private lines or public switched services from local and long-distance carriers and Internet providers, often utilizing encrypted communications. WANs, which connect multiple LANs across cities, countries, or continents, are increasingly dominant in today's globalized business environment, supporting modern enterprises' expansive reach and reliance on remote access technologies.

Network management involves centrally monitoring and controlling LANs and WANs using software like IBM's NetView and HP's OpenView, with SNMP being the standard protocol and numerous third-party add-ons available. Since the late 2000s, smart phones and tablets have

expanded a company's local network, increasing complexity for network administrators. Mobile security is a growing industry, with users using Apple iOS, Android, Windows Phone, and BlackBerry devices. The World Wide Web, introduced in the mid-1990s, revolutionized the IT world, setting new standards and transforming the way we access information. It has influenced every component of system software, including operating systems and applications; and now nearly every new application deals with the Internet.

Business network management is being revolutionized by Software-Defined Wide Area Network (SD-WAN) technology, which improves efficiency and dependability across sites. Businesses with various branches or cloud-based applications can benefit from its sophisticated and flexible management of connections between offices, data centers, and cloud services. A software-based system called SD-WAN replaces inflexible infrastructures with an agile configuration to maximize data flow over a network. It ensures peak performance and reduces interruptions by dynamically routing traffic and adapting to changing circumstances. By integrating cutting-edge security features, it enhances network performance and digital infrastructure management strategically.

Benefits of Enterprise Networking

Enterprise networking is vital for entrepreneurs in today's competitive business world, enabling expansion, building connections, and support. It promotes teamwork, resource access, and creative alliances. An effective enterprise networking must encourage entrepreneurs to embrace new technologies and innovate for long-term success, fostering a strong network of friends and associates. However, there are other benefits of enterprise networking such as:

1. Collaboration among employees which can enhance efficiency by allowing them to work on shared resources remotely or in various locations such as offices, factories, or campuses.

2. Provision of shared knowledge, insights, and industry trends, enabling feedback and discussion, and allowing access to experienced group members to stay ahead of the curve.

3. Ensuring controlled access to organization’s resources through perimeter and internal firewalls, enabling secure connectivity to applications and data.

4. Offering growth opportunities through referrals, partnerships, and service requests, expanding access to potential clients, partners, investors, and mentors.

5. Connecting attendees, strengthening relationships, and fostering collaborations and partnerships through mutually beneficial relationships.

6. Server and network virtualization optimizes resource allocation across on-premise and cloud infrastructure, offering cost-effective solutions for analytics, monitoring, and security, enhancing business operations.

7. Regular networking and pushing oneself out of a person's comfort zone can boost confidence, which is crucial for business growth as it fosters connections with others.

8. Networking boosts visibility, reputation, and leads. Attending events and providing advice boosts profile, attracting more leads and referrals.

9. Effective networking enables entrepreneurs to connect with diverse individuals, gain insights into new technologies, industry trends, and innovative strategies, and foster collaboration for joint ventures, co-creation, and business expansion.

Enterprise Networking Strategies

Enterprise networking strategies are strategic initiatives to achieve professional goals by building relationships with industry professionals. They help business owners coordinate daily decisions with long-term organizational goals, ensuring positive outcomes. These strategies, particularly on platforms like LinkedIn, Twitter, and Google Meet, enhance career development, industry knowledge, and professional contacts for future reference. Proactive planning, establishing connections with the appropriate individuals, having strategic talks, and gaining credibility are all necessary for effective business networking. Entrepreneurs have to make sure that business information systems deliver the appropriate data at the appropriate time in the appropriate manner. Individuals in various fields and roles frequently aim to establish deep connections with other experts. These kinds of connections can be made by using particular networking techniques. Gaining knowledge about these various tactics could assist one in developing career plans and engaging in relationship-building exercises.

As a means of exchanging professional references, advice, and information, networking is an essential tactic for entrepreneurs. It can strengthen collaborations and abilities connected to careers. Weekly or monthly **meetings of networking organizations** facilitate information exchange and meetings between members from different businesses and professions. Meetings in person can also be beneficial for building relationships within the neighborhood. **Social**

networking platforms give workers the ability to network with other professionals in their community and sector, manage relationships, talk about previous work experiences, and find new opportunities. Entrepreneurs can maintain ties to their companies by **offering referrals** and making it simple for former co-workers to make requests. A **compilation of personal details** about people an entrepreneur has encountered in a commercial or professional context, such as networking groups, hiring managers, partner organizations, and organization members, is called a professional contacts database. It helps in applying for new jobs, getting references, and getting professional guidance. Industries often have **professional groups** for networking, fostering partnerships, sharing strategies, and establishing positive relationships. These groups often share common interests and responsibilities, offering benefits for career growth and skill development within the same market. **Conventions and conferences** offer professionals the chance to connect, share ideas, and participate in activities. These events can lead to new projects and partnerships, such as atmospheric science conferences, where scientists can learn about each other's research and form network relationships. **Emails** are a powerful tool for establishing connections, checking in, and communicating messages simultaneously. Including an introduction, asking questions, and sharing personal work activities can foster positive relationships. Using multiple emails simultaneously can also facilitate advice, polls, or meet-ups. **Informational interviews** involve asking individuals about their background, experience, skills, and abilities to gain insights into their job or industry. Experienced professionals are ideal candidates for these interviews. They can help entrepreneurs decide career advancement or career changes, develop relationships, and create mentorship relationships, such as with software development Chief Executive Officers (CEOs). **Offering assistance** in networking can strengthen relationships and positively reflect an entrepreneur. This can include providing professional advice, acting as a reference, facilitating introductions, helping with projects, or joining a board. Offering assistance also allows for easier requests for help when needed. The future of enterprise networks requires agile, robust architectures for high-performance applications, necessitating a comprehensive approach to network development, deployment, and maintenance to ensure scalability, security.

Traditional enterprise networks are adapting to digitalization and expanding connectivity. Building flexible networks today is crucial for success in the digital economy. Companies are

transitioning from static to intelligent networks, enabling next-generation digitization. This includes SD-WAN, NFV, automation, multi-cloud connectivity, bundled services, monetization models, SaaS interconnects, embedded security, and advanced analytics. Enterprises must re-visit their network orchestration strategies to gain competitive edge. Companies must adapt to new technologies like big data analytics, edge computing, IoT, and Artificial Intelligence (AI) to drive operational efficiencies. Legacy architectures hinder growth and innovation, while blindly migrating can increase costs. Transitioning to predictive and automated platforms requires innovative strategies to mitigate network risks. Technology companies, CSPs, and network architects must manage complexity while unlocking growth opportunities. Migrating clients from legacy hardware to software-based platforms requires customized solutions.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurship is a lifelong career with diverse opportunities, and technology plays a crucial role in facilitating career growth and innovation. Enterprise networking, consisting of physical and virtual networks, protocols, and components like servers, switches, and routers, is essential for entrepreneurs to build trust and foster relationships. New technologies like 5G and Wi-Fi are improving security and data transmission in enterprise networking, while cloud-managed adoption continues to enhance capabilities. Effective networking strategies involve proactive planning, strategic talks, and credibility, establishing connections, dependable data, compelling concepts, and dedicated individuals. Social networking platforms, professional contacts databases, industry groups, conventions, and emails are essential tools for networking. As digital transformation intensifies and the need for flexible networking and customized solutions increases, they necessitate agile, robust architectures for high-performance applications and innovative strategies to mitigate network ri

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